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INDIA BULLDOZE NEW ZEALAND IN FINAL, DEFEND T20 WORLD CUP TITLE

BLUE MAGIC! 1-SIDED GLORY

S KANNAN

AHMEDABAD: Riding on explosive batting strength right from the top, led by man-in-form Sanju Samson (89) and the burst of brilliance from Abhishek Sharma (52), India showed no mercy to crush New Zealand by 96 runs and lift the ICC T20 World Cup on Sunday night. If the batting was full

of muscle, the fired-up Indian bowling attack, led by local hero Jasprit Bumrah (4 for 15 in 4 overs) and 'Bapu' Axar Patel (3 for 27) reduced the Kiwis to rubble. They were all out for 159 in 19 overs.

The emotions and joy which gripped Ahmedabad and entire India was felt at 1045pm, when the last wicket fell. Crackers being burst, danc-

CHAMPIONS!
CONGRATULATIONS TO
INDIAN TEAM
ON WINNING
ICC MEN'S T20
WORLD CUP

PM Modi

ing impromptu and more was the mood as India sealed the

deal. Inside the Narendra Modi Stadium, over 1,20,000 fans screamed and wept. To win the T20 World Cup at home for the first time was massive. The last time India had achieved a World Cup win was in the ODI format in 2011 in Mumbai, when MS Dhoni was the skipper. Tonight, Dhoni, Rohit Sharma and legend Kapil Dev, all invited for the grand finale, savoured the

triumph just like every other Indian cricket fan. Ahmedabad had turned into a riot of colours from Sunday afternoon, with the real-feel temperature at 43 degrees Celsius. Inside the Narendra Modi Stadium, a 360-degree seating view, 'Bleed Blue' was the theme as fans fortunate to get a ringside view cheered Team India lustily. To say that **Continued on P4**

ISRAEL SUFFERS FIRST TROOP LOSSES | SAUDI ARABIA REPORTS 2 DEATHS

Day 9: Oil, water in war's crosshairs

ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI: The US and Israel continue to strike Iran, hitting oil storage depots and refining facilities in Tehran for the first time on Sunday. An Iranian drone attack caused material damage to a water desalination plant in Bahrain, the country's interior ministry said.

Israel on Sunday struck southern Lebanon, Beirut and oil storage facilities in Tehran as the war in the Middle East keeps escalating, and Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu promised "many surprises" for the next phase of the conflict.



Earlier Sunday, Iran's Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said a US airstrike damaged an Iranian desalination plant on Qeshm Island, warning that

in doing so "the U.S. set this precedent, not Iran." Such infrastructure is critical for drinking water supplies in the parched deserts of the Gulf. **Continued on P4**

International law is dead, says Moscow

MOSCOW: Russia has said international law is effectively dead amid escalating tensions in West Asia following the US-Israeli strike on Iran, and called for reviving President Vladimir Putin's proposal to convene a summit of the five permanent members of the UN Security Council. Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov said the current global situation underscores the need to revisit Putin's proposal, first made before the COVID-19 pandemic, for a summit of the P-5 -- Russia, the US, China, France and the UK -- to discuss global security and stability. **See P8**

Nitish's son Nishant begins JD(U) journey

PATNA: Bihar Chief Minister Nitish Kumar's son Nishant Kumar joined the JD(U) on Sunday and said he would work to strengthen the party's organisation.

Nishant, an engineering graduate who is in his 40s, was inducted into the party at its headquarters here in the presence of top leaders, including Union minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh 'Lalan' and JD(U)'s national working president Sanjay Jha. **Continued on P4**

CAPITAL BOOST



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Union Minister of Housing and Urban Affairs Manohar Lal and Delhi CM Rekha Gupta during the inauguration and foundation stone laying ceremony of multiple development projects, in New Delhi, on Sunday

NO-TRUST MOVE, WEST ASIA CRISIS TO DOMINATE

Session back, Birla in focus

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Budget Session of Parliament will resume on Monday after the recess with an Opposition-sponsored resolution seeking removal of Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla all set to be taken up on the first day itself even as the Opposition parties of INDIA bloc are sharpening its arsenal to grill the Modi government over the ongoing West Asia conflict, Iran, Epstein Files and Indo-US trade deal.

The second leg of the session, which ends on April 2, in all likelihood will see a stormy start as the ruling BJP would be

KEY POINTS

- » The ongoing conflict in West Asia is also likely to figure prominently as the Opposition is already attacking the government over its stance towards Iran
- » Besides, the outcome of the SIR of electoral rolls in poll-bound West Bengal,



which led to the deletion of nearly 60 lakh votes, is also expected to cast its shadow on parliamentary proceedings

using the Parliamentary platform to corner the Opposition, especially against the backdrop of soon-to-be held assembly elections in Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Puducherry, Assam and

West Bengal, the schedule of which is likely to be announced in the coming days.

The ongoing conflict in West Asia is also likely to figure **Continued on P4**

Rapper shakes Nepal politics

KATHMANDU: The newly formed Rastriya Swatantra Party (RSP) of rapper-turned-politician Balendra Shah has secured a landslide victory in Nepal's general elections, decimating the established parties in the politically fragile Himalayan nation. Formed in 2022 by Ravi Lamichhane, the party has already won 117 of the 165 directly elected seats while it is leading in another eight in the House of Representative elections, according to the Election Commission (EC).

Results for 152 of the 165 seats have been announced so far by the EC. The Nepali Congress (NC) is a distant second, winning 17 seats. **See P8**

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VICTIM'S FAMILY SEEKS CBI PROBE

Uttam Nagar: Bulldozer action as tensions simmer after Holi clash killing

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Authorities on Sunday demolished alleged “illegal” portions of a house linked to one of the accused in the Uttam Nagar Holi clash case in which a 26-year-old man was killed, even as the victim’s family demanded a CBI probe and strict action against all those involved in the incident.

A team of MCD officials reached the JJ colony with bulldozers and razed parts of the house belonging to Nizamuddin, the father of accused Umardeen, sources said, while police and paramilitary remained deployed in strength to prevent any flare-up in the area that has been gripped by tension since the March 4 incident. As the demolition action against the accused, perhaps the first such instance in Delhi in recent years, was carried out, the police cordoned off the area and a large number of residents gathered nearby to watch the operation.

While the MCD remained tight-lipped over the action, an official of the civic body, requesting anonymity, said it was part of a civic exercise to remove encroachments built over drains that obstruct the flow of water, especially with the monsoon season approaching. Police have so far arrested seven people and apprehended a juvenile in connection with the case, Deputy Commissioner of Police (Dwarka) Kushal Pal Singh said.

The latest arrest was that of Imran alias Bunty (38), who was taken into custody on Sunday in connection with the killing of Tarun (26) following a clash between two families during Holi celebrations.



Police officials at the site, after Municipal Corporation of Delhi, carried out a demolition drive and razed illegal portions of a house

“The killing sparked anger among residents, with an agitated mob damaging vehicles and setting some of them on fire”

The accused arrested earlier have been identified as Umardeen (49), Jummadeen (36), Kamruddin (36), Mustaque (46), Muzzafar (25) and Tahir (18), while a juvenile was also apprehended in the case.

The police said stringent provisions of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act have also been invoked in the case after statements of members of the victim’s family.

According to the police, the violence erupted after water from a balloon thrown by a girl from Tarun’s family splashed on a woman from the neighbouring family during Holi celebrations in the densely populated JJ Colony area.

What began as a minor argument soon escalated into a violent confrontation between members of the two families and their supporters. The police said the two families had known each other for nearly five decades and had earlier

been involved in disputes over issues such as parking and garbage disposal in the locality.

Tarun sustained fatal injuries during the attack. The killing sparked anger among residents, with an agitated mob damaging vehicles and setting some of them on fire on Friday, prompting authorities to increase security deployment across the area.

“Companies of the Rapid Action Force (RAF) and Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) have been deployed in the area, along with additional forces drawn from the western range of the Delhi Police, including personnel from the outer and west districts,” the DCP said. Heavy police deployment continues in Uttam Nagar after Tarun’s killing, with zones set up for monitoring. The victim’s family demanded a CBI probe and strict punishment, while protests, shop closures and Eid-season business losses reflected ongoing tension.

Bishnoi among 3 discharged by court in extortion case

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A Delhi court has discharged gangster Lawrence Bishnoi and two others in a case related to an alleged Rs 1 crore extortion call, saying the prosecution failed to place sufficient material on record to establish the essential ingredients of the offences.

Chief Judicial Magistrate Nupur Gupta discharged Haren Sarapdadiya, Lawrence Bishnoi and Ashish Sharma in a case registered at the Sunlight Colony police station under Section 387 (putting a person in fear of death or grievous hurt in an attempt to commit



extortion) of the Indian Penal Code (IPC) on a complaint by Raman Deep Singh.

The complainant alleged that between the midnight of April 23 and 24, 2023, he began receiving calls from an unknown number threatening his life and demanding Rs

1 crore. After investigation, the police filed a chargesheet against the accused under Sections 386 (extortion by putting a person in fear of death or grievous hurt to themselves or another person) and 387 read with Section 120B (criminal conspiracy) of the IPC.

The court, however, noted that the offence of extortion under Section 386 IPC requires actual delivery of property induced by fear of death or grievous hurt, which was absent in the case. “Neither the complainant has alleged any delivery of property under threat nor the same has been alleged in the entire

charge-sheet,” the court said in its order dated February 20.

It further observed that even for the offence under Section 387 of the IPC, the prosecution failed to show any “overt act” indicating that the accused had put the complainant in fear of death or grievous hurt.

“The complainant has merely alleged that he received calls from an unknown number demanding an amount of Rs 1 crore. On perusal of the complaint itself, it can be said that nothing has been mentioned at all about the physical act, rather it has simply been said he was asked to pay a particular sum of money,” the court said.

The judge also pointed out that investigators did not procure call records or collect other material evidence and that the case primarily relied on disclosure statements of the co-accused persons.

“Apart from the disclosure statement, there is no evidence on record to constitute the offence with which the accused persons have been chargesheeted,” the court said while ordering the discharge of the accused. The court directed the accused to furnish bail bonds of Rs 20,000 with one surety each. On March 6, upon furnishing bail bonds, the trio was discharged.

E Delhi school bars class 12 students from exam over parents’ refusal to pay hiked fee

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Four class 12 students of a private school in east Delhi’s Mayur Vihar have allegedly been barred from taking the exam on Monday over non-payment of fees, according to parents.

The parents said they had refused to pay the hiked fee and were subsequently issued a notice by the school stating that the names of the students had been struck off under provisions of the Delhi School Education Rules, 1973.

There was no immediate

Parents said they had refused to pay the hiked fee and were subsequently issued a notice

response available from the school on the matter.

In the notice dated March 7, the school informed the parents that the students’ names would be removed from the rolls with effect from March 9 if the outstanding dues were not cleared.

The school cited Rule 35

of the Delhi School Education Rules, 1973, which allows institutions to strike off the name of a student in case of non-payment of fees.

The notice also stated that unaided recognised private schools do not require prior approval from the Director of Education before fixing fees for an academic year, and referred to various court judgments. The school has asked the parents not to send the students to school from March 9 onwards if the pending dues are not cleared, according to the notice.

Fake iPhone parts racket busted, five held

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police Crime Branch has arrested five shopkeepers after busting a factory involved in manufacturing counterfeit Apple iPhone spare parts, seizing fake components worth around Rs 1.60 crore.

Police said the action followed a tip-off received by the Crime Branch regarding the illegal unit. Acting on the information, a team from the North-

ern Range-I conducted raids as part of an ongoing drive against economic offences and the sale of counterfeit goods.

According to officials, the accused were allegedly cheating customers by selling fake iPhone spare parts and accessories while passing them off as genuine products of Apple Inc..

On March 6, a Crime Branch team patrolling the Rohini area received specific

inputs that shops in Vikas Surya Shopping Mall and Mangalam Place at M2K in Sector 3 were selling counterfeit Apple products.

Acting on the information, the team formed a raiding party and called Tauqueer Chaudhary, the authorised representative of Apple Inc., to assist in the operation. Simultaneous raids were conducted at five shops — Dinesh Spare Part, Singhal’s Mobile Acces-

sories, Pardhan Ji Communication, Satguru Accessories and Kansal Accessories Nxt.

Police seized around 1,000 iPhone back panels, 180 back bodies, 228 batteries, 48 camera and charging flex units, 738 back covers, 14 adapters and 109 USB-C cables. The accused have been booked under the Copyright Act and the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. Further investigation is underway.

Two apprehended for murder of teen after clash between rival groups in Jahangirpuri

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has arrested a man and apprehended a juvenile for the murder of an 18-year-old following a violent clash between two rival groups in Jahangirpuri, officials said.

Police said they received a PCR call about the incident at the Jahangirpuri police station on March 3. The accused has been identified as Hasmat alias Ashu (23), son of Anwar alias Anu, a resident of CD Park in Jahangirpuri.

According to investigators, the murder stemmed from a long-standing rivalry between two groups in the locality. The case was registered on March 4



under Sections 103(1), 115(2) and 3(5) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and Section 27 of the Arms Act at the Jahangirpuri police station.

The incident occurred around 6 pm on March 3 outside a jhuggi in CD Park, where a quarrel broke out between

the groups. During the clash, firing and stone-pelting allegedly took place, leaving three people injured.

The injured were taken to Babu Jagjivan Ram Memorial Hospital and later referred to Lok Nayak Jai Prakash Narayan Hospital for further treatment.

One of the victims, Rehmatulla alias Bhola (18), who sustained a gunshot wound, later succumbed to his injuries.

Two others — Aftab (18), who suffered a head injury due to stone-pelting, and Sahjaan Ali, who sustained a stab wound — were also injured.

Based on the complaint of eyewitness Jamir Ahmad, police formed a special team and conducted raids at suspected hideouts. Hasmat was arrested and a juvenile accomplice apprehended. A country-made pistol and a live cartridge were recovered from Mangal Bazar at the instance of the accused. Police said efforts are underway to arrest other associates involved in the crime.

Anurag Dobhal hospitalised after livestream crash near Ghaziabad

DIPIKA KIROLA

GHAZIABAD: Anurag Dobhal, a popular moto vlogger from Dehradun and a former contestant on Bigg Boss 17, was reportedly involved in a serious car crash in Ghaziabad while livestreaming on Instagram on Saturday evening. A video of the incident has since gone viral on social media.

Dobhal, widely known as UK07 Rider, was reportedly driving his Toyota Fortuner at a speed of around 150–180 kmph while interacting with followers during the live session. During the broadcast, he appeared emotional and spoke about personal issues involving his family and ongoing mental stress.

While speaking during the livestream, the vehicle allegedly lost control and crashed into a road divider at high speed

According to officials, Dobhal was travelling from Dehradun towards Delhi when the accident occurred. While speaking during the livestream, the vehicle allegedly lost control and crashed into a road divider at high speed.

The impact reportedly caused the SUV to flip and land on the opposite lane of the highway heading towards Dehradun. The livestream

ended abruptly seconds after the crash.

Surendra Nath Tiwari said that by the time police were informed, Dobhal’s friends and nearby people had already shifted him to a hospital in Meerut. He was later referred to another hospital in Delhi and is currently stable.

Prior to the accident, Dobhal had posted emotional messages on social media alleging mental harassment by family members and referring to disputes related to property and issues following his inter-caste marriage with Ritika.

During the livestream before the crash, he appeared visibly distressed and referred to the drive as his “final ride”.

AT JAI SINGH ROAD VENUE

Suvidha Camp receives 70 public grievances

Over 100 NDMC officials attend camp, offering on-the-spot redressal, guidance

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) organised a Suvidha Camp at the NDCC Convention Centre on Jai Singh Road, receiving 70 public grievances and providing residents with a platform to seek assistance on civic issues and services.

The civic body said the camp was aimed at strengthening citizen-centric governance by offering a single-window system for facilitation, information sharing and speedy redressal of complaints related to municipal services in NDMC areas.

According to officials, the grievances largely related to departments such as personnel, civil engineering, horticulture, public health, enforcement, commercial, taxation and estate management. In addition to registered complaints, several



residents visited the camp to obtain information and guidance regarding various civic services.

Officials noted that one of the key features of the camp was the opportunity for direct interaction between citizens and departmental representa-

tives. Such face-to-face engagement allowed complainants to present their concerns in detail while enabling officials to examine cases and provide clarifications immediately.

Wherever possible, grievances were resolved on the spot after discussions with the

HIGHLIGHTS

► It highlighted the role of its digital grievance system, the ‘Jan Suvidha Portal’, which allows residents to file complaints online, track the status of their requests...

► Officials added that complaints received via social media platforms such as Twitter, Facebook and Instagram are also monitored regularly & addressed

concerned departments.

For issues requiring policy-level decisions or further examination, residents were informed about the process and the expected timeline for resolution.

More than 100 officers and officials from over 30 depart-

ments participated in the camp, with dedicated help desks set up to handle different categories of complaints. The desks were supervised by the respective Heads of Departments to ensure prompt and accountable response to public grievances.

The civic body also highlighted the role of its digital grievance system, the “Jan Suvidha Portal”, which allows residents to file complaints online, track the status of their requests and submit feedback.

Officials added that complaints received through social media platforms such as Twitter, Facebook and Instagram are also monitored regularly and addressed by the concerned departments.

The NDMC said such initiatives are aimed at improving accessibility and strengthening public engagement in civic administration.

FOCUS ON IMPROVING PUBLIC TRANSPORT AND URBAN INFRA

PM unveils, lays foundation for Rs 33,500 crore projects

AIMAN FATIMA & NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday inaugurated and laid the foundation stone for multiple development projects worth around Rs 33,500 crore in Delhi, emphasising a renewed push to modernise infrastructure and improve quality of life in the national capital. In his address to a huge crowd of people, Modi said that these projects would provide a new momentum to the growth of Delhi.

The Prime Minister inaugurated two new corridors of the Delhi Metro and laid the foundation stone for three additional corridors under Phase V(A), projects worth more than Rs.18,000 crore that are expected to strengthen connectivity across the capital. These include the Majlis Park–Maujpur–Babarpur corridor of approximately 12 km and the Majlis Park–Deepali Chowk corridor of approximately 9 km. With the commencement of these corridors, travel will become easier for lakhs of people across Delhi. In particular, areas in Trans-Yamuna such as Wazirabad, Khajuri Khas, Bhajanpura, Yamuna Vihar and Karawal Nagar will receive Metro connectivity for the first time.



These projects include the expansion of the metro network and modern accommodation for thousands of government employees, which clearly shows the impact of the 'Double Engine Government' on the growth of Delhi over the past year.

Highlighting improvements in transport infrastructure, the Prime Minister said Delhi has witnessed significant growth in public transit facilities. In his speech on infrastructure development, Modi said that Delhi has been witnessing rapid growth in public transport infrastructure. The metro network has been expanded to around 375 km.

Emphasising the importance of connectivity, the Prime Minister also referred to initiatives such as the Namoo Bharat Train. In addition to that, Modi said that efforts to improve inter-regional connectivity through initiatives like the Namoo Bharat Train demonstrate India's growing confidence to showcase itself on the world stage. "The more modern, convenient, and better connected Delhi becomes, the more strongly India's self-confidence will be visible to the world," Modi remarked.

The work done by the Central govt to improve the cities across the country has been mission-based

Speaking about public transport improvements, the Prime Minister said that the Centre has been strengthening the capital's bus fleet with a focus on clean mobility. He said that more than 4,000 electric buses funded by the Centre are already on the roads and that 1,800 more have been added to the fleet over the past year, including "Devi Buses" to improve connectivity within the city's neighbourhoods. "While over four thousand electric buses provided by the Centre are already operational, an additional 1,800 new buses have been deployed in the last year alone, including hundreds of 'Devi Buses' designed to enhance last-mile connectivity across Delhi's colonies and neighborhoods," Modi remarked.

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CM Gupta says Delhi govt working in mission mode

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Sunday said her government has been working in "mission mode" over the past year to address long-pending civic issues in the capital, while emphasising that the expansion of the Delhi Metro network will make daily travel safer and easier, particularly for women.

Speaking at an event in New Delhi where Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated two metro corridors and laid the foundation stone for three more, Gupta highlighted the government's efforts to improve civic infrastructure and strengthen welfare initiatives for residents of the national capital.

Addressing the gathering, the chief minister said the government has worked with dedication over the past year while focusing on improving governance and service delivery. "We have tried to serve the residents of Delhi with truth and honesty," she said, adding that the administration has been functioning in "mission mode" to resolve key urban challenges.

Gupta said the government has launched several initiatives aimed at supporting the poor and workers in the city. She noted that 70 Atal Canteens have been set up across Delhi,



where meals are provided at a subsidised price. "Meals are being provided for ₹5 to the poor, the needy and workers, and around 70,000 people receive food in these canteens every day," she said.

The chief minister also spoke about steps taken to tackle long-standing issues such as pollution and waterlogging. According to her, the government has prepared a new drainage master plan for the capital after nearly five decades. "A new drainage master plan has been brought for the city after 50 years to address these long-standing issues," she said, adding that the administration is taking concrete steps to improve urban infrastructure.

Highlighting welfare measures for girls, Gupta said the government utilised unclaimed funds from earlier schemes to ensure benefits reach the intended recipients. "We used

unclaimed funds to provide ₹200 crore to the daughters of Delhi so that the benefits of earlier schemes reach those who truly need them," she said.

She also underlined administrative reforms undertaken by the government, noting that all departments of the Delhi administration have been digitised. Initiatives include the e-file system, digital hospital records, online OPD booking, digital asset management, project management portals and the CM Jansunwai app.

In the education sector, Gupta said major steps have been taken to improve digital infrastructure in schools. "Schools in Delhi have been equipped with 7,000 smart classrooms, 275 computer labs and 100 digital libraries," she said.

Meanwhile, Union Minister for Housing and Urban Affairs Manohar Lal Khattar described the metro network as the "life-line" of the city. "The metro saves both time and money for passengers while also helping reduce pollution," he said.

Union minister Manohar Lal Khattar said India's metro network has expanded from 245 km in five cities in 2013–14 to over 1,100 km. Projects worth ₹18,300 crore were announced, including two new corridors and three Phase V-A routes.

PM Modi inaugurates housing, office projs under major GPRA redevelopment in Delhi

NEW DELHI: In a major push to modernise government housing and office infrastructure in the national capital, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday inaugurated and laid the foundation stone for several projects under the ambitious redevelopment of seven General Pool Residential Accommodation (GPRA) colonies in New Delhi. The initiative, being implemented by NBCC (India) Limited under the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, is expected to create more than 21,000 modern residential units along with large-scale office infrastructure while generating



significant employment and boosting urban redevelopment in the capital.

The Prime Minister inaugurated more than 2,700 newly constructed government flats and key office infrastructure while also laying the founda-

tion stone for over 6,600 additional GPRA flats and eight towers of the upcoming Bharat Business Park in Sarojini Nagar.

Earlier in the day, Modi visited the GPRA redevelopment site in Sarojini Nagar along with Union Minister for Housing and Urban Affairs Manohar Lal Khattar and Housing and Urban Affairs Secretary Srinivas Katikithala. At the site, women officers from NBCC briefed the Prime Minister on the progress of the project. He also interacted with women workers involved in construction and handed over allotment keys to a few women beneficiaries on the occasion of Inter-

national Women's Day. The formal inauguration and foundation-laying ceremony was later conducted virtually from Burari in the presence of Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and Union Minister of State for Housing and Urban Affairs Tokhan Sahu.

The redevelopment programme approved in 2016 aims to build over 21,000 modern housing units across seven colonies. Implemented through a self-financing model, it has generated 3.55 crore man-days of employment and will create modern commercial and residential infrastructure. MPOST

Civic officials inspect sanitation & waste management in MCD zones

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) carried out special sanitation drives in the Najafgarh and Shahdara South zones as part of efforts to strengthen waste management and improve civic cleanliness across the Capital.

In the Najafgarh Zone, a large-scale cleanliness drive was conducted across several wards under the supervision of senior civic officials. The inspection was led by B.S. Jaglan, Additional Commissioner of the zone, along with the Deputy Commissioner and other departmental heads.

Officials undertook on-ground inspections to review sanitation conditions at public

places and assess the status of waste disposal and general cleanliness. During the drive, the team visited several garbage-vulnerable points in Ward No. 117 (Dabri), Ward No. 136 (Madhu Vihar) and Ward No. 137 (Mahavir Enclave).

During the inspection, Jaglan directed field officials to take strict action against illegal encroachments and ensure regular removal of waste to minimise garbage accumulation and reduce dust pollution. Officials were also instructed to maintain sanitation standards across all wards and ensure routine monitoring of cleanliness in the zone.

Meanwhile, in the Shah-

dara South Zone, Additional Commissioner Pankaj Naresh Aggarwal conducted an early morning surprise inspection to assess sanitation conditions and the status of municipal waste management in the area.

The inspection team, accompanied by the Deputy Commissioner and heads of departments, reviewed road sweeping operations, lifting of municipal waste, management of construction and demolition (C&D) waste, and the cleanliness of public conveniences at several locations.

Officials inspected sanitation across several areas, noting minor C&D waste issues. MPOST

Delhi Police marks Int'l Women's Day



NEW DELHI: Delhi Police observed International Women's Day 2026 across several districts through awareness campaigns, community outreach and public engagement programmes aimed at promoting women's safety, empowerment and legal awareness.

Activities held in the run-up to and on the day included self-defence training sessions, lectures on "good touch and bad touch", cyber safety awareness drives, health check-up camps, a women's scooter rally and felicitation ceremonies. The initiatives focused on increasing awareness about women's rights, personal safety and available police support systems. In the North-West district, a self-defence session was conducted at GGS School in Adarsh Nagar to train students in basic safety techniques. Similar programmes were organised under the Parivartan Cell and Nazuk Scheme.

In Outer-North district, police organised an awareness programme with Pahal NGO at Mahila Park in Rohini, focusing on legal rights, cyber safety and the Himmat Plus.

Workshops and lectures were also held in Rohini, South, South-East, Dwarka and West districts. A women's scooter rally from Maurice Nagar to Miranda House and a felicitation of women police personnel in East district were among the highlights. MPOST

CM Rekha Gupta leads Women's Day 'Shakti Walk' at Kartavya Path



OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A vibrant display of women's strength and leadership marked the celebration of International Women's Day in the national capital on Sunday as Chief Minister Rekha Gupta joined nearly 3,000 women for the 'Shakti Walk' – #SheLeadsBharat at Kartavya Path. The event, organised by the Ministry of Women and Child Development, celebrated the leadership, resilience and contributions of women across sectors.

The walk began at India Gate and concluded at Vijay Chowk, covering a distance of nearly two kilometres. Alongside the Chief Minister, Union Minister for Women and Child Development Annapurna Devi and Union Ministers of State Anupriya Patel and Savitri Thakur also participated in the event.

Addressing the gathering, Gupta described the initiative as a tribute to women's leadership and achievements. "This initiative is an inspiring effort dedicated to honouring women, their leadership and their contributions to society," she said.

Highlighting the changing role of women in modern India, the Chief Minister said, "Women are not only

the foundation of families and society but are also emerging as strong partners in nation-building." She added that under the leadership of Narendra Modi, women are increasingly occupying leadership positions and excelling in fields such as science, administration, entrepreneurship, education, sports and defence. Calling the event a symbol of collective commitment, Gupta said, "The 'Shakti Walk' is not merely an event but a collective pledge to honour and empower women." She added that women's "strength, sensitivity and leadership are capable of guiding society towards a new direction."

She further emphasised that empowering women is key to national progress. "When women are empowered through access to education, healthcare, employment and leadership opportunities, the progress of both society and the nation is ensured," she said. The event saw women from armed forces, police, healthcare, sports and government sectors participate, along with Anganwadi and ASHA workers. The programme featured themed installations, a cultural performance at India Gate and concluded with medals for participants.

Day temp hits 35.6°C

NEW DELHI: The Capital recorded a maximum temperature of 35.6 degrees Celsius on Sunday, 7.2 degrees above the seasonal average, according to the India Meteorological Department. The minimum temperature settled at 16.7 degrees Celsius, 2.7 degrees above normal.

The city had already experienced an unusually hot spell a day earlier. On Saturday, the temperature touched 35.7 degrees Celsius, making it the hottest first week of March in the past 50 years.

The India Meteorological Department has forecast a partly cloudy sky for Monday, with the maximum and minimum temperatures likely to be around 37 degrees Celsius and 17 degrees Celsius respectively.

Relative humidity was recorded at 90 per cent at 8.30 am on Sunday but dropped to 29 per cent by 5.30 pm. MPOST

Delhi Tourism unveils double-decker bus tour

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In an effort to promote experiential tourism in the Capital, the Delhi Tourism and Transportation Development Corporation (DTTDC) has launched a special double-decker bus tour allowing visitors to witness the ceremonial Change of Guard at Rashtrapati Bhavan. The initiative is aimed at offering residents and tourists a closer look at one of the most iconic ceremonial traditions of the country.

According to officials, the tour was organised to encourage people to engage with the heritage, culture and ceremonial practices associated with the President's residence. The Change of Guard ceremony, performed by the President's Bodyguard, reflects military discipline and the ceremonial grandeur linked to the office of the President of India.

The special tour will operate



every Saturday at an affordable cost of ₹200 per person. The inaugural ride was attended by media representatives, influencers and travel vloggers who participated in the experience and shared their impressions of the initiative.

During the journey, our correspondent interacted with a travel blogger who described the initiative as an "interesting and beautiful way to explore Delhi". She said the double-decker electric bus offered a

comfortable travel experience and included food facilities for passengers. "Considering the price, the facilities were quite impressive," she said, adding that the panoramic upper deck allowed you travellers to enjoy views of the city's landmarks.

However, she pointed out one concern regarding the height of the bus. According to her, the large structure occasionally brushes against roadside trees, which could pose a challenge on certain

stretches of road.

Among the passengers were an elderly couple who said they had long been associated with tourism activities in the city and were delighted to be part of the ride. They described the journey as enjoyable and appreciated the initiative to make Delhi's heritage more accessible to visitors.

In addition to this service, Delhi Tourism has also introduced the "Dekho Meri Dilli" sightseeing circuit starting from Dilli Haat INA, covering key landmarks including the National Museum, the National Gallery of Modern Art, the Pradhanmantri Sangrahalaya and the National War Memorial.

Officials said the initiative reflects the government's focus on sustainable mobility and tourism, with the electric double-decker buses combining environmental responsibility with a unique sightseeing experience.

SOOD HIGHLIGHTS ROLE OF FITNESS INITIATIVES IN BUILDING HEALTHY SOCIETY

Over 10,000 women join Pinkathon run on Women's Day

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Marking International Women's Day with a strong message of fitness and empowerment, Delhi's Education and Sports Minister Ashish Sood on Sunday flagged off the Zyudus Pinkathon Run at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium. The event witnessed enthusiastic participation from more than 10,000 women, highlighting the growing momentum for women's health, fitness and empowerment in the national capital.

The run was organised as part of the nationwide Pinkathon movement that encourages women to adopt an active and healthy lifestyle. vice chairperson of Zyudus Foundation Meha Patel, fitness icon Milind Soman and Ankita Konwar were also present at the event.

Participants from different age groups joined the run with the message of "Healthy Women, Empowered Nation," emphasising the importance of women's health and well-being. The event also celebrated women who have participated in long-distance runs of 100 km, 75 km and 50 km, recognising their determination and achievements in endurance sports.

Speaking at the event, Education and Sports Minister Ashish Sood said the enthusiasm shown by women participants was inspiring. "Although every day is Women's Day, it is extremely inspiring to see such a large number



of women early in the morning on March 8, International Women's Day, participating in the run with awareness about their health," he said.

Highlighting the significance of the Pinkathon movement, Sood added that the initiative goes beyond a sporting event. "Pinkathon is not just a run but a move-

ment that encourages women to believe in their strength, challenge their limits and live a healthy, empowered and confident life," he said.

The minister also referred to the Fit India Movement launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, stating that the event was organised to further strengthen the message of fit-

'Although every day is Women's Day, it is extremely inspiring to see such a large number of women early in the morning on Women's Day'

ness and healthy living among citizens. He noted that the large participation of women reflects the growing awareness about health and physical activity.

Sood emphasised the role of women in building a strong society and nation. "A healthy woman is the foundation of a healthy society, a healthy nation and a healthy family,"

he said. "The vision of Viksit Bharat @2047 cannot be fulfilled without the contribution of the women of our country."

He added that under the leadership of Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and the guidance of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the Delhi Government is working at multiple levels to strengthen sports culture in the capital. "Such programmes not only inspire and encourage women towards fitness but also promote a healthy and positive lifestyle in society," the minister said. Appreciating the efforts of Milind Soman and Ankita Konwar for promoting the Pinkathon initiative, Sood said the campaign is motivating women across the country to embrace fitness and move forward with confidence.

RAINS FORECAST IN HIMACHAL, KASHMIR NEXT WEEK

Temperature rises above normal across various northern states

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Day temperatures hovered above the seasonal average across northern states on Sunday, even as the weather department has predicted that a fresh western disturbance would bring wet spells in Himachal Pradesh and Jammu and Kashmir next week.

In the national capital Delhi, the maximum temperature was recorded at 35.6 degrees Celsius, 7.2 notches above normal, while the minimum temperature settled at 16.7 degrees Celsius, 2.7 notches above the usual.

Among the hill states, Himachal Pradesh witnessed "severe heat wave" in Dharamsala and Bhuntar, while "heat wave" was experienced in Sundernagar.

The minimum temperatures for most of the stations in the state were above normal by

Highlights

» Among the hill states, Himachal Pradesh witnessed "severe heat wave" in Dharamsala and Bhuntar, while "heat wave" was experienced in Sundernagar

» The Shimla Met office has issued a yellow warning for heat wave in three districts on Monday -- in Kangra, Mandi and Kullu

» In the desert state of Rajasthan, mercury touched the 40 degrees Celsius mark at two places, while it was closer to the figure in many others

3-7 degrees, while maximum temperatures were above normal by 3-12 degrees.

The Shimla Met office has issued a yellow warning for heat wave in three districts on Monday -- in Kangra, Mandi and Kullu.

Kashmir too witnessed above normal day temperatures on Sunday, with the departures ranging from 9.4 to 10.7 degrees Celsius.

Srinagar recorded a max-

imum temperature of 24.3 degrees Celsius, 9.6 degrees above normal.

Pahalgam tourist resort in south Kashmir's Anantnag, which serves as one of the base camps for the annual Amarnath Yatra, registered a high of 20.8 degrees Celsius, 9.4 degrees above average.

The famous ski resort of Gulmarg in north Kashmir recorded a maximum temperature of 14.2 degrees Celsius,

9.6 degrees more than the season's average.

In the desert state of Rajasthan, mercury touched the 40 degrees Celsius mark at two places, while it was closer to the figure in many others.

Pilani in Jhunjhunu district was the hottest in the state, recording a maximum temperature of 40.2 degrees Celsius, followed by Barmer at 40 degrees Celsius.

Bikaner recorded 39.4 degrees Celsius, Churu (39.1 degrees), Jaisalmer (39.2 degrees), Jodhpur city (38.8 degrees), Fatehpur-Sikar (38.5 degrees), Vanasthali and Phalodi (38.2 degrees each), Jaipur (37.1 degrees) and Sri Ganganagar and Jhunjhunu (37.4 degrees each).

According to the India Meteorological Department, hot weather conditions are likely to continue in several parts of Rajasthan over the next

few days.

Temperatures were above normal in Punjab and Haryana as well.

Hisar in Haryana was the warmest in the two states, recording a maximum temperature of 37.5 degrees Celsius, which was six notches above normal.

Chandigarh, the common capital of the two states, recorded a maximum temperature of 32.3 degrees Celsius, six notches above normal.

In Haryana, Ambala recorded a high of 32.3 degrees Celsius, 6 degrees above the seasonal average, while Naraul hit 36.7 degrees, 5 notches up.

Karnal recorded 31.6 degrees, Gurugram 34.3 degrees, and Bhiwani 36.5 degrees.

In Punjab, Faridkot recorded a high of 33.5 degrees Celsius.

Iran conflict: Indian airlines cancel 279 international flights

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Indian airlines cancelled 279 international flights on Sunday due to the ongoing situation in the Middle East.

The escalating conflict in the region involving the US, Israel and Iran has significantly disrupted flight operations due to airspace closures and restrictions.

The civil aviation ministry on Sunday said that due to the ongoing situation in the Gulf, flight operations have been impacted across several sectors.

"A total of 49 flight operations were scheduled today by Indian domestic carriers from West Asia to India. As on 8 March, 279 flights scheduled to be operated today by Indian domestic carriers have been cancelled," the ministry said in a post on X.

An official said that a total of 66 flights, including 34 departures and 32 arrivals, were cancelled at the Mumbai airport on Sunday.

The civil aviation ministry on Sunday said that due to the ongoing situation in the Gulf, flight operations have been impacted across several sectors

Delhi airport operator DIAL said that due to the current geopolitical developments in the Middle East, some west-bound international flights may experience delays or schedule changes.

Meanwhile, Air India will operate 78 additional flights on nine international routes from March 10 to 18 to provide more travel options for passengers amid the disruptions due to the Middle East conflict.

Punjab known as 'Food Bowl & Sword Arm of India', says Bhagwant Mann

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann exhorted the Punjabi Diaspora to play a proactive role in restoring the pristine glory of Punjab while addressing a gathering during India International Week.

Extending a warm welcome to the distinguished dignitaries who arrived from across the world to the sacred land of Punjab, CM Mann said that the delegation includes eminent legal scholars, heads of legal institutions, lawyers, and other distinguished personalities.

He profusely thanked the organisers of India International Disputes Week-2026 for choosing Chandigarh, the capital of Punjab, as the venue to bring together respected legal minds from across the world on a single platform.

The Chief Minister said he was delighted to know that the delegation also includes Sikh



lawyers, judges, and other eminent Sikh personalities from the USA, UK, Canada, and Singapore who have come to the sacred land of their ancestors. "Among them are several distinguished personalities who, through their talent, dedication, and hard work, have achieved great success abroad. I personally feel proud of their achievements and these moments are equally a matter of pride for all Punjabis," said CM Mann.

Welcoming the guests, CM said, "Government of Punjab feels honoured to host you all.

Punjab is the sacred land of great Gurus, saints, and spiritual leaders. The state is known as the land of brave and hard-working people. Our soldiers safeguard the borders, while our farmers ensure the nation's food security. Therefore, Punjab is proudly known as the 'Food Bowl and Sword Arm of India'.

Highlighting the social fabric of the state, CM Mann said, "Punjab is a peaceful state where harmony, mutual respect, and brotherhood are so strong that hatred cannot germinate. Punjabis have always

set a beautiful example of communal harmony before the world. The holy city of Amritsar is known as a symbol of universal brotherhood, where sacred sites such as Sri Harmandir Sahib, Durgiana Temple, Bhagwan Valmiki Tirath Sthal, and Jallianwala Bagh are located."

Speaking about the significance of the legal forum, Mann stated, "India International Disputes Week is a platform that brings together judges, senior lawyers, law firms, young lawyers, intellectuals, and institutions from across the world. Over the course of five days, discussions will be held on various important legal subjects including Domestic Violence, Financial Crime, Public Interest Litigation, Environmental Law, Media Regulation, Mediation Strategy, Cross-Border Settlements, and other key topics. I hope that this initiative will also prove beneficial and meaningful for the common people."

CENSUS 2027

House listing operations to begin in Arunachal Pradesh on April 16

ITANAGAR: The Arunachal Pradesh government has announced that the house listing operations (HLO) of Census 2027 will begin across the state on April 16, an official said.

The HLO, to be conducted in the first phase, is an important exercise of the Census process, Census Operations Arunachal Pradesh assistant director Chafikhur Rahman said in an official statement on Sunday.

He said the HLO helps the government collect basic information about buildings, houses, and households. The data collected during this phase will support better planning and implementation of development programmes.

"Accurate information from the Census helps the government understand housing conditions, availability of basic

mitment to their empowerment.

She noted that rural women are becoming economically self-reliant through self-help groups and providing leadership in village development, while women continue to emerge as leaders in employment, start-ups, and the corporate sector.

Conveying greetings to all women, Modi said the achievements of India's 'Nari Shakti' are a source of pride.

He said empowerment of women is at the core of his government's various schemes and initiatives, and it remains committed to creating opportunities that enable every woman to realise her full potential and contribute to India's journey of development.

"On International Women's Day, I extend my greetings to all our Nari Shakti. Across every field, women are shaping India's progress with determination, creativity and unmatched zeal. Their achievements inspire our nation and strengthen our collective resolve to build a Viksit Bharat," he said in a message.

From Page 1 Blue magic!

Suryakumar Yadav's men were a class act would be no exaggeration. Batting, bowling and the sublime catches taken by Ishan Kishan in the outfield, defined the intensity India showed on the field. Chasing a mountain of a target, the Kiwis had in Tim Seifert an opening batter who threatened India.

Yet, once he fell for 52, consumed by Varun Chakravarthy, courtesy an Ishan Kishan catch, the plot was lost. Lower down, captain Mitchell Santner hung around. On this day the skipper needed to score fast and furious, but the runs he put on the board were insufficient.

Credit for this will be the variety in the bowling, where pace and spin, subtle variations, made so much difference.

There was no venom in the pitch, so what the Indian bowlers achieved was even more credible.

Earlier on, call it nerves, the Black Caps were clueless for most part. Santner won the toss and asked India to bat first. What followed was a bizarre sequence where Santner was shuffling his bowler so fast from the first over, it looked out of sync. It clearly showed Santner had not come in with a proper plan to calm the Indian openers, Sanju Samson and Abhishek Sharma, whose turbo knock was a real delight.

There were questions asked if Abhishek deserved to play, after a sequence of failures. Indeed, the team management's decision to persist with dashing left-handed Abhishek Sharma, whose hand-eye coordination, bat speed and geometry of shots created was so slick, New Zealand had no clue where to bowl. It was clear, Abhishek was playing fearless cricket, despite the noise from the stands, where fans screamed

themselves hoarse. Prior to the match, the tone had been set by pop music from Ricky Martin and Sukhbir Singh's 'Ishq Tera Tadpave'.

If the music from the professional singers was prelude, what followed from the bats of Sanju Samson and Abhishek Sharma was also like heavy metal. Abhishek Sharma has been under immense pressure. Yet, the glint in his eyes tonight was visible behind the helmet visor, as he treated the Kiwi bowling with contempt. His shots were timed to a nicety as he was fearless, even though the boundary at the Narendra Modi Stadium is much longer than in Mumbai's Wankhede Stadium where India won the semi-final.

To be sure, it was a contrast of sorts watching the two openers, one in aggro mode, and Sanju ready to take his time. For sheer power and being punitive, Abhishek Sharma's 52 off 21 deliveries, studded with six fours and three sixes defined domination. The flow of runs which continued from the Indian batters was defined by Ishan Kishan. Calm and quiet, Kishan puts immense pressure on the bowlers with his game sense and creativity with the bat. It was a joy to watch his 54 runs, off just 25 deliveries, where he mastered the Kiwi bowling attack. Four fours and an equal number of sixes was proof he could step on the accelerator, again and again in this World Cup.

If Ishan Kishan was potent, what came from the blade of Shivam Dube, a thorough team man, was explosive. His 26 runs off eight balls came after James Neesham had rocked India for a brief phase with a three-wicket haul. But then, as has been a pattern in this World Cup, Dube used his long reach and sweet timing to loot runs, which enabled India to score 255 in 20 overs.

Day 9

An Israeli attack on oil storage

sites in Tehran sent up pillars of fire that could be seen in Associated Press video as a glow against the Saturday night sky. It appeared to be the first time a civil industrial facility has been targeted in the war.

The war, which erupted on Feb. 28 after joint U.S.-Israeli strikes hit Iran, has so far killed at least 1,230 people in the Islamic Republic, more than 300 in Lebanon and around a dozen in Israel, according to officials.

Iran foreign minister said his country is looking for a permanent end to the war, not a ceasefire. But before Tehran might even consider a ceasefire, Abbas Aragch said "they have to explain why they started this aggression." Aragch did not specify about whom he was speaking.

Aragchi also told NBC's "Meet the Press" that "there should be a permanent end of the war and unless we get to that, I think we need to continue fighting for the sake of our people and our security."

He said the war "was imposed on us" by the United States and Israel, and that "what we are doing is legal acts of self-defense and we have every right to do that."

The US State Department said more than 32,000 Americans have left the Middle East since the start of the Iran war last week.

Although most of them departed on commercial flights without government assistance, the department said Sunday that it had organized nearly two dozen charter flights that had carried several thousand US citizens from the Mideast to destinations in Europe and the United States.

The Israeli military announced that two soldiers were killed in fighting in southern Lebanon on Sunday.

They are the first military fatalities since the start of the war with Iran last week.

One of the soldiers was identified as 38-year-old Maher Khatar, from the Druze village of Majdal

Shams in the Israeli-annexed Golan Heights. The military has not published the name of the second soldier as his family is still being notified.

An Iranian official deplored the U.S.-Israeli strikes on oil facilities in Iran, saying they pushed the war into a "dangerous phase."

"These attacks on fuel storage facilities amount to nothing less than intentional chemical warfare against the Iranian citizens," Foreign Ministry spokesman Esmail Baqaei said in a social media post.

He said such attacks will have "devastating the environment, and endangering lives on a massive scale" because of hazardous materials and toxic substances they release into the air.

"The consequences of this environmental and humanitarian catastrophe will not be confined within Iran's borders," he said.

Lebanon's top diplomat has condemned a drone attack apparently launched from Lebanese territory that hit a British airbase on the southern coast of Cyprus.

Youssef Rajji's remarks Sunday come after his Cypriot counterpart Constantinos Kombos said an exploding drone that hit the British Royal Air Force's Akrotiri on Monday originated from Lebanon territory, where the Hezbollah militant group is at war with Israel. Hezbollah's arsenal notably includes exploding drones, similar to the ones used by Iran.

As Beirut scrambles to make amends, French President Emmanuel Macron will visit the European Union island nation Monday. The attack puts Lebanon in a predicament, as Macron is leading the only diplomatic endeavor to try to halt the conflict, which has killed almost 400 people in Lebanon and displaced hundreds of thousands.

Firefighters have controlled fires at the Kuwait International Airport and a government agency in Kuwait City, hours after both facilities were hit in missile and drone attacks early Sunday.

The General Fire Force said in a statement that it managed to

control fires at fuel tanks in the airport as well as the headquarters of the State-run Public Institution for Social Insurance.

Spokesman Brig. Gen. Mohammed Badr said the fire damaged both the tanks and the insurance agency building. No casualties were reported, he said.

Meanwhile, President Abdel-Fattah el-Sissi of Egypt expressed concerns about the war in the Middle East and its "grave repercussions, including rising energy prices and disruptions to supply chains and air and maritime traffic."

He warned of the dangers of the conflict expansion which he said could plunge the entire region into chaos, the Egyptian president said. He called for intensified international efforts to stop the war.

Nitish's son

After joining the party, Nishant said, "My father decided to go to the Rajya Sabha. It was his personal decision. We all respect it. We will keep working under his guidance. I will work to strengthen the organisation."

Nishant claimed his father, as the longest-serving chief minister of Bihar, did a lot for the state in the last twenty years.

People of the state will never forget the CM's contribution to the state's development, he said.

"I thank everyone. I will honour the trust you all have placed in me. The country, our state and I are proud of what my father has done in the last 20 years. I will take the development work done by the CM to the masses," Nishant said.

Nitish's son received a rousing reception at the JD(U) office on his arrival.

Party functionaries gathered outside the office and were seen waving party flags and beating drums.

Speculation is rife that Nishant

will be made deputy CM in the new government.

A close aide of Nitish Kumar claimed on Saturday that a unanimous decision had been taken to make Nishant deputy CM in the new government to be formed upon his father's resignation.

CM Nitish Kumar filed his nomination papers for the Rajya Sabha polls on Thursday.

JD(U) MLA from Harnaut, Hari Narayan Singh, claimed that Nishant would be elected to the state legislative council next month.

Session back

prominently as the Opposition is already attacking the government over its stance towards Iran, the US "waiver" on India's Russian oil purchase, among other issues.

Besides, the outcome of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in poll-bound West Bengal, which led to the deletion of nearly 60 lakh votes, is also expected to cast its shadow on parliamentary proceedings.

The no-confidence resolution against Birla was given by several opposition leaders who alleged that he had acted in a "blatantly partisan" manner in the House.

They had also accused the speaker of making certain false claims against the Congress members when he spoke of some "unexpected action" in the Lok Sabha and had asked Prime Minister Narendra Modi not to come to the House to reply to the debate in the Motion of Thanks on the President's Address.

Birla had recused himself from the proceedings of the House from the date of submission of the notice, with the Lok Sabha secretariat saying he would return only after the disposal of the agenda.

On Saturday, Prime Minister Modi backed Birla, saying he had taken all Parliamentarians along and was committed to the prin-

ciples of the Constitution and Parliamentary democracy.

Apart from the no-trust notice, the US-Israel strikes on Iran and growing tensions in West Asia that have led to disruption in crude oil supplies and escalation in prices are also likely to come up during the session.

The opposition is expected to question the government's policy on the matter.

TMC MPs are set to raise the heat on the SIR matter in the House, while the BJP may raise the issue of President Droupadi Murmu's "protocol breach" during her visit to West Bengal on Saturday.

The government is also expected to pilot the Electricity Amendment Bill in the remainder of the budget session, besides taking up other pending legislative business from the first half of the session.

According to the agenda paper for Monday, the resolution against the Speaker is the only item listed in the Lok Sabha business of the day.

Both the ruling BJP and the principal opposition Congress have issued a whip to their respective Lok Sabha MPs to be present in the House when the issue comes up for consideration.

The numbers are heavily stacked in favour of the government, which will ensure that the resolution is defeated.

The Congress has called for a debate on the notice given by 118 MPs while the Trinamool Congress has also said that it would support the resolution against Birla.

The Lok Sabha may not take up the Question Hour between 11 am and 12 noon on Monday, as it may get adjourned to pay respect to sitting member from Shillong Ricky Syngkon who passed away on February 19.

Three Lok Sabha speakers - G V Mavlankar (1954), Hukum Singh (1966) and Balram Jakhar (1987) - had faced no-confidence motions in the past, which were negated.

CALLS US PRESIDENT ‘DICTATOR’

Mallikarjun Kharge attacks govt over Trump and trade

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KALABURAGI: AICC President Mallikarjun Kharge on Sunday said US President Donald Trump is a “dictator” and Prime Minister Narendra Modi is his “ghulam” (slave), as he targeted the BJP-led government at the Centre over its stand on the ongoing Middle Eastern crisis, trade deal with the USA, and tariff issue.

Addressing a gathering after launching various development projects worth Rs 1,069 crore in Chittapur here, he claimed that Modi is “controlled” by Trump using the Jeffrey Epstein files.

“It (Iran) is also a country, its supreme leader was murdered... if the leader of a country is killed will that country and the world be safe? Think about it. Whether it is Iran’s Ayatollah Ali Khamenei or Venezuela’s leader (Nicolas Maduro Moros). If leaders of countries are threatened like this, there will be no peace in



Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge, Karnataka Deputy CM DK Shivakumar and others during the groundbreaking and foundation stone-laying ceremony for various development works, in Chittapur

the world,” Kharge said, as he accused the US for its “arrogance” and violating international laws.

Also, targeting India’s trade deal with the USA, he claimed that India was forced to accept it, where it cannot impose tariffs on the import of several agricultural products, while the Americans impose tariffs on what India exports to them.

“Sixty five per cent of our farmers are dependent on agriculture, while it is 3 per cent in America. What will happen to our farmers? With friendship with such people (Trump), you (Modi) are destroying our country, pushing it to slavery. You have pledged the country for American interests. You act as America says,” he added.

Pointing out that India used

Highlights

- » Kharge claimed that Modi is ‘controlled’ by Trump using the Jeffrey Epstein files
- » Targeting India’s trade deal with the USA, Congress president said claimed that India was forced to accept it

BJP vows to root out graft under 20-point programme for BMC

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: The BJP is implementing a 20-point programme for the first 100 days in the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation, focusing on corruption-free administration, and has already completed six tasks within a month, party leaders said on Sunday.

Chief Minister Devendra Fadnis asked newly-elected BJP corporators to work towards a corruption-free administration and fulfil the aspirations of Mumbaikars while addressing a two-day training camp in Dadar on Sunday.

Following the chief minister’s address, Mumbai BJP president and MLA Ameet Satam, Mayor Ritu Tawde, Standing Committee Chairman Prabhakar Shinde, Education Committee Chairperson Rajshree Shirwadkar and Leader of the House Ganesh Khankar addressed a press conference and announced the programme.

“Out of the 20-point programme for the first 100 days, six points have already been implemented,” Satam said.

He said the completed works included a decision to procure 27 school items for BMC schools through the Government e-Marketplace (GeM) portal.

Satam said community-level cleanliness competitions have been started, and action was initiated to develop entry points to the city.

VB G RAM G ACT Govt launches logo design contest

NEW DELHI: The Rural Development Ministry said a logo design competition for the Viksit Bharat-Guaranteee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act (VB G RAM G) has been launched.

The competition is live on the government’s citizen engagement platform MyGov, the ministry said in a post on X on Saturday, inviting people to submit creative designs reflecting the vision of rural development and employment generation.

The ministry said it seeks to promote public participation in branding the programme, which is a key pillar of the government’s rural development strategy aligned with the vision of “Viksit Bharat 2047”.

The last date for submitting

The last date for submitting entries is March 20

entries is March 20, and the winner will receive a cash prize of Rs 50,000.

In a post on X, the ministry said the logo should reflect the vision of a developed India.

According to details shared on the MyGov portal, the selected design will be adopted by the ministry for official and promotional use related to the Act and associated programmes. The competition seeks original logos that symbolise employment generation, livelihood enhancement and inclusive rural growth.

The Viksit Bharat - “Guaranteee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act, 2025, replaces the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 and provides a statutory guarantee of up to 125 days of wage employment in a financial year to rural households whose adult members volunteer for unskilled manual work.

Activists and Opposition parties have criticised the VB G-RAM-G scheme, alleging that it weakens the rights-based framework of MGNREGA, may dilute legal guarantee of work, and have also alleged that the new scheme is more centralised than MGNREGA, which was drafted after widespread consultations.

UP: Seer who moved court against Shankaracharya attacked inside train

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

PRAYAGRAJ: A seer who had moved a court seeking registration of an FIR against Shankaracharya Swami Avimukteshwaranand Saraswati was attacked with a sharp weapon inside the Rewa Express early on Sunday, leaving him injured.

The seer, Ashutosh Maharaj Brahmachari, said the attack took place around 5 am when the train was nearing Sirathu Railway Station in Kaushambi district.

He alleged that some unidentified men assaulted him with a sharp weapon while he was travelling in the AC coach H-1 of the train.

In his complaint to the Government Railway Police in Prayagraj, Ashutosh Brahmachari said he had boarded the train from Ghaziabad Railway Station on Saturday night and was on his way to Prayagraj. He alleged that the attackers suddenly targeted him inside the

coach, leaving him bleeding.

The seer said he managed to escape by locking himself inside the toilet of the coach and remained there until the attackers left.

He later reached Prayagraj in an injured condition and was taken to a hospital for medical examination. Doctors said his condition is currently out of danger.

Ashutosh Brahmachari claimed that the attack was a conspiracy and expressed suspicion against Shankaracharya Swami Avimukteshwaranand Saraswati and his associates. He has submitted a written complaint to the GRP seeking registration of an FIR.

GRP Deputy Superintendent of Police Arun Kumar Pathak said action is being taken to register a case against unidentified assailants and the matter is under investigation.

He added that the injured seer has been admitted to hospital and his condition is stable.

CPI(M) slams Centre over LPG price hike, demands rollback

NEW DELHI: The CPI(M) on Sunday hit out at the government over the steep hike in LPG prices, accusing it of an “anti-people” stance by “refusing” to reduce taxes on cooking gas cylinders.

In a statement issued here, the CPI(M) Politburo expressed strong opposition to the price increase affecting both domestic as well as commercial consumers.

The Left party noted that the Rs 60 hike for domestic cylinders would heavily impact poor beneficiaries of the Ujjwala scheme.

“The hike in the prices of commercial cylinders by Rs 114.50 will also ultimately be passed on to the consumers. Together, these will impose greater burdens on middle-class and working people who are already reeling under relentless price rise and shrinking real incomes,” the statement said.

UP govt to provide financial support to girls from birth till graduation: CM

OUR CORRESPONDENT

LUCKNOW: Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath on Sunday said the state government is working to make girls self-reliant and will provide them a comprehensive package of financial assistance from birth until graduation to support their education.

Addressing a programme organised on the occasion of International Women’s Day, the chief minister launched the mobile application of the Rozgar Sangam portal, distributed appointment letters to newly selected sevikas and attended the Pink Rozgar Mahakumbh 2026.

“Daughters will no longer be dependent on anyone. From birth to graduation, the government will provide a package to support their education,” he said.

SLAMS GOVT ON RISING POLLUTION Cong demands review of National Ambient Air Quality Standards

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Expressing concern over rising pollution levels, the Congress on Sunday demanded an urgent review and upgradation of the National Ambient Air Quality Standards, 2009, and asserted that they must be enforced as well as monitored more effectively everywhere.

Taking a swipe at Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh said, “PM 56-inch has been exposed, PM 2.5 is for real,” said Ramesh

Ramesh also said the National Clean Air Programme (NCAP) itself needs a laser-like focus on PM2.5.

“PM2.5 that is, particulate matter with a diameter of less than 2.5 micrometers or lower measured in micrograms per cubic meter of air as emerged as the cause for a severe environment-public health crisis across the country,” the former environment minister said on X.

Closer Look

- » ‘PM 56-inch has been exposed, PM 2.5 is for real,’ said Ramesh
- » ‘National Clean Air Programme itself needs a laser-like focus on PM2.5’

A study published in The Lancet Planetary Health in December 2024, based on data from 655 districts over 2009-2019, found that every 10 microgram per cubic metre increase in PM2.5 concentration leads to an 8.6 per cent increase in mortality, Ramesh pointed out.

The 2025 Lancet Countdown estimates that about 17.2 lakh Indians die every year from exposure to PM2.5, a 38 per cent increase since 2010, he said.

The Ministry of Environment, Forests and Climate Change has repeatedly told Parliament in 2024, 2025 and again in 2026 that deaths on

account of air pollution “cannot be conclusively established”, he pointed out.

Meanwhile, the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR), the Health Ministry’s own research body, has endorsed the Lancet findings, attributing 12.4 lakh deaths in 2017 to air pollution, that is 12.5 per cent of all deaths that year, Ramesh said.

Now, the Centre for Research on Energy and Clean Air (CREA) has done a detailed analysis of the data generated by the continuous ambient air quality monitoring stations operated by the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB), he said, adding that the data covers the period October 1, 2025 to February 2026 for 238 cities.

The conclusions are very disturbing and should be yet another wake-up call to all those who are in denial mode, he said.

Citing the analysis, Ramesh said none of the 238 cities complied with the WHO safe guidelines for PM2.5.

AAP govt honoured biggest poll promise: CM Mann

Unveils the ‘Mukh Mantri Mawaan Dhian Satkar Yojna’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Sunday said his government fulfilled its biggest electoral promise by unveiling the ‘Mukh Mantri Mawaan Dhian Satkar Yojna’ to provide monthly financial assistance to women.

Under the scheme, general category women will receive Rs 1,000 per month, while women from Scheduled Caste

communities will receive Rs 1,500, with Rs 9,300 crore earmarked in the state budget for its implementation.

Mann said the AAP government’s ‘Saari Guarantiyan Puri’ Budget delivers on its poll promises by expanding welfare measures such as free bus travel, free power and cashless healthcare to empower women.

Interacting with the media here, Mann congratulated the women of Punjab on International Women’s Day.

He said special camps will be organised across the state so that women can easily complete the formalities required to avail the benefit of the scheme.

The registration process for the financial assistance scheme will begin from the coming Baisakhi and will be carried out on a war footing, he said.

Every woman above 18 will be entitled to receive the benefit under the scheme, he said. “This is not merely a

budget but an affidavit of the progress of the state and the prosperity of its people,” he said.

Taking a dig at previous governments, Mann said earlier budgets often remained confined to announcements on paper and failed to deliver meaningful benefits to the people. Budgets were limited to rhetoric and poetic references rather than concrete policies aimed at improving the lives of citizens, he added.

India set to lead global homoeopathy with certified quality frameworks: Experts

For decades, German homoeopathy brands have enjoyed a premium global reputation

MPPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India, home to one of the world’s largest homoeopathy ecosystems, is set to emerge as a global leader in the sector, driven by strong clinical expertise, large-scale practitioner networks, and internationally recognised quality certifications and standards.

For decades, the German homoeopathy brands have enjoyed a premium global reputation, often being perceived as the gold standard in quality, consistency, and research-backed manufacturing. AYUSH experts said.

However, they said that India is not only on track to match but even surpass them, driven by two powerful quality frameworks - the AYUSH

Key Points

- » According to industry reports, the country has over 2.5 lakh registered homoeopathy practitioners
- » The global homoeopathy market is valued at over USD 8 to 10 billion

Premium Mark and NABL accreditation.

According to industry reports, the country has over 2.5 lakh registered homoeopathy practitioners, nearly 300 teaching institutions, and millions of patients relying on homoeopathy as their primary or complementary system of medicine.

The global homoeopathy

market is valued at over USD 8 to 10 billion, with Europe accounting for a significant share, historically dominated by Germany. Experts believe that quality-backed Indian brands are now well-positioned to challenge this dominance.

“The key differentiator lies in certified quality and scientific validation,” said Pradeep Prajapati, Director of the All India Institute of Ayurveda (AIIA). He added that the AYUSH Premium Mark, launched by the Ministry of AYUSH, represents global-level compliance in manufacturing, safety, and quality management for AYUSH products.

The NABL (National Accreditation Board for Testing and Calibration Laboratories) certification ensures interna-

tionally benchmarked accuracy, reliability, and reproducibility in testing and quality control – aligned with ISO standards recognised across Europe and beyond, Dr Prajapati explained.

Rajeshwar Tiwari, a senior representative from the Ministry of AYUSH, said India has unmatched clinical data, practitioner strength, and patient diversity in homoeopathy.

“When this experiential advantage is supported by certified quality frameworks like AYUSH Premium and NABL, Indian homoeopathy gains scientific credibility that is globally comparable. This integration of research, regulation, and manufacturing excellence is essential for competing with established European brands,” Tiwari said.

 सेन्ट्रल बैंक ऑफ इंडिया Central Bank of India 1911 से आपके लिए "सेन्ट्रल" "CENTRAL" TO YOU SINCE 1911		Regional Office Delhi (North) 1398, First Floor, Chandni Chowk, Delhi-110006		E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE (Under SARFAESI Act 2002)			
APPENDIX- IV-A [SEE PROVISO TO RULE 8(6) & 9(1) SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES							
E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) & 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.							
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the borrower(s) and guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged / charged to the Central Bank of India (secured creditor), the constructive/ physical Possession of which have been taken by the authorized officer of Central Bank of India (Secured creditors), will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on date 30.03.2026 for recovery of dues to the Central Bank of India from below mention Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s). The Reserve Price and Earnest money deposit (EMD) is displayed against the details of respective properties.							
E-AUCTION SCHEDULED TO BE HELD ON 30.03.2026 (15 DAY'S NOTICE)							
S. No.	Name of Branch	Authorised Officer / B.M.	Name of the Account	Description of Property & Owner Name	Demand Notice Date & Amount Dues (in Rupees)	Date & Type of Possession	In Rupees Reserve Price EMD Bid Increase
1.	Akshardham Delhi	Mr. R. S Mishra Mobile: 7354650300	Rahul Gupta	Residential Flat No. NyayKhand-3/411, E.W.S Ground Floor Without Roof Rights, Loni Indrapuram Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh. Area-24.65 Sq Mtr Owner- Mr. Rahul Gupta	01.09.2023 Rs.13.16 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	10.10.2025 (Physical)	₹ 9,50,000.00 ₹ 95,000.00 ₹ 10,000.00
2.	Indirapuram Ghaziabad	Ms. Sandhya Sharma Mobile: 8800013517	Bhairaw Ghosh	Residential builder flat, 2nd floor, flat no. S-2, Plot No. 88, Shalimar Garden Extension-1, Ghaziabad, UP, Area- 520 Sq feet (Owner- Mr. Bhairaw Ghosh)	31.10.2015 Rs.17.77 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	09.09.2017 (Physical)	₹ 13,86,000.00 ₹ 1,38,600.00 ₹ 15,000.00
3.	L R P G Ghaziabad	Mr.Vipin Kumar Mobile: 8800013520	Aarti Kapoor and Nitin Kapoor	Flat No. 304 MIG First Floor Right Hand Back Side Without Roof Rights, Situated at plot No. B-11/15, DLF Ankur Vihar, Hadbast Village-Sadullabad, Pargana & Tehsil Loni Distt. Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh. Area-55.74 Sq Mtr Owner - Aarti Kapoor W/o Nitin Kapoor	22.11.2023 Rs.22.43 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	02.12.2025 (Physical)	₹ 21,60,000.00 ₹ 2,16,000.00 ₹ 20,000.00
4.	MMH College Ghaziabad	Ms. Shikha Aryanee Mobile: 8800013525	Mahipal Singh S/o Shri Kundan Singh	Property Bearing No.35-A Entire Ground Floor Khasra No.1025, Without Roof Rights New Friends Colony, Hadbast Village Dargal, Pargana- Jalalabad, Tehsil & Distt. -Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh Area 65 Sq Mtr Owner- Mahipal Singh S/o Kundan Singh	30.06.2017 Rs.16.52 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	12.11.2025 (Physical)	₹ 20,34,000.00 ₹ 2,03,400.00 ₹ 20,000.00
5.	Patel Nagar Ghaziabad	Mr. Vinod Meena Mobile: 8800013533	Abhay Sharma	Flat Bearing No. G-01, Ground Floor Without Roof Rights, Plot No. 46, out of Khasra No.- 1586, Krishna Enclave, Vill- Harsaon, Tehsil and Distt. Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh. Area- 57.00 Sq Mtr Owner- Abhay Sharma	02.07.2019 Rs.14.38 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	09.01.2026 (Physical)	₹ 13,42,000.00 ₹ 1,34,200.00 ₹ 15,000.00
6.	Patel Nagar Ghaziabad	Mr. Vinod Meena Mobile: 8800013533	Soniya W/o Vikaram Singh	Residential Flat No. NyayKhand-3/487, E.W.S Ground Floor Without Roof Rights, Loni Indrapuram Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh Area-24.65 Sq Mtr Owner- Ms. Soniya W/o Vikram Singh	01.03.2025 Rs.9.67 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	05.12.2025 (Physical)	₹ 11,00,000.00 ₹ 1,10,000.00
7.	Patparganj Road, Delhi	Mr. Indresh Kumar Mobile: 8800013534	Shefall Aqua Solutions	First Floor (Adjoining to Property No. 87), Without Roof Rights, Upto the extent of Ceiling Level, Part of Property Bearing No. 86 out of Khasra no.5/30, Situated in layout plan of Ram Nagar in the Area of Village Khureji Khas, Illaga Shahdara, Delhi-110051 Area- 85 Sq Yard Owner- Sapna W/o Rakesh Kumar	26.10.2018 Rs.29.28 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	12.01.2026 (Physical)	₹ 40,70,000.00 ₹ 4,07,000.00 ₹ 40,000.00
8.	Ushmanpur Delhi	Mr. Husnain Ali Mobile: 9568431985	Mushahid Alam	Property Bearing No. F-32 & F-33, Ground Floor, Pvt Flat No. GF-2, W/without Roof/terrace Rights, Situated at Colony SLF Ved Vihar, Pargana- Loni, Tehsil and Distt. Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh- 201102. Area- 400 Sq Ft Owner- Mushahid Alam S/o Jamshed Alam	28.05.2024 Rs.10.45 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	19.07.2025 (Physical)	₹ 11,52,000.00 ₹ 1,15,200.00 ₹ 10,000.00
9.	Ushmanpur Delhi	Mr. Husnain Ali Mobile: 9568431985	Sudha Bhaskar & Manish Kumar Bhaskar	Flat No. F-5, First Floor, LIG, Back Portion, Without Roof, Plot No. B-1/151, Colony Dlf, Dilshad Extn., Village Brahampur Urf Bhopura, Pargana- Loni, Tehsil And Distt- Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh Area 41.805 Sq Mtr. Owner Sudha Bhaskar	21.05.2021 Rs.12.53 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	09.04.2025 (Physical)	₹ 16,00,000.00 ₹ 1,60,000.00 ₹ 15,000.00
E-AUCTION DATE: 30.03.2026, TIME: 12:00 NOON TO 04:00 PM WITH AUTO EXTENSION OF 10 MINUTES							
Last Date & Time of Submission of EMD and Documents (Online) On or Before: 30.03.2026 Upto 03:30 PM.							
Bidder will register on website: https://BAANKNET.com and upload KYC documents and after verification of KYC documents by the service provider, EMD to be deposited in BAANKNET EMD wallet through NEFT/RTGS/Transfer / Generation of challan from (https://BAANKNET.com). The auction will be conducted through common landing platform BAANKNET.com Portal (https://BAANKNET.com). E-auction will be held "As is where is", "As is what is" and "whatever there is" basis. (All other charges/ dues to the property will be borne by the purchaser). For detailed terms and conditions please refer to the link provided in www.centralbankofindia.co.in Secured Creditor or auction platform (https://BAANKNET.com). Helpdesk: (+91) 8291220220, E-mail: support.BAANKNET@psballiance.com							
STATUTORY 15 DAY'S SALE NOTICE UNDER RULE 8(6) & 9(1) OF THE SARFAESI ACT, 2002							
Borrowers/Guarantors/ Mortgageors are hereby notified to pay the sum as mentioned above along with upto date interest and ancillary expenses before the date of e-auction, failing which the property will be auctioned/sold and balance dues, if any, will be recovered with interest and cost.							
DATE: 07.03.2026 PLACE: DELHI				Authorised Officer, CENTRAL BANK OF INDIA, RO Delhi (North), Delhi			

INTERNATIONAL WOMEN'S DAY

Women are strong, no less than others: Prez Murmu

Achievements of India's 'Nari Shakti' a source of pride, says Prime Minister Narendra Modi

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: President Droupadi Murmu and Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday lauded the strength, achievements and contributions of women to nation-building on the occasion of International Women's Day, emphasising the need to further empower women and ensure equal opportunities in all spheres of life.

Addressing an event organised by the Ministry of Women and Child Development in the national capital, Murmu said the occasion was not only to celebrate women's achievements but also to reaffirm the nation's commitment to their empowerment. She highlighted the pioneering roles played by women in education, administration, judiciary, armed forces,



President Droupadi Murmu, left, during the International Women's Day celebrations organised by the WCD ministry in New Delhi

medicine, science, technology, arts, entrepreneurship and sports.

The President noted that women are increasingly taking leadership roles across sectors. She pointed out that rural women are becoming eco-

nomically self-reliant through self-help groups and are playing an important role in village development. At the same time, women are emerging as leaders in employment, start-ups and the corporate sector.

"With opportunity and sup-

I grew up in family where women were bosses: Rahul tells students

NEW DELHI: Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Sunday said women are often more intelligent than men and play a crucial role in shaping society, as he extended greetings on International Women's Day.

Posting a video of his recent interaction with women students in Kerala on his YouTube channel, Gandhi said he grew up in a family where "the women were the bosses".

Gandhi said he was deeply impressed by the students' dreams, curiosity and confidence during the lunch interaction.

"Such conversations remind us that when women recognise their potential and move forward with an open mind, they can bring about extraordinary change," he said.

While acknowledging the port, women can excel in every sphere," Murmu said, adding, "Mahilao mei dam hai, hum kisi se kam nahi. Hum mei bhi dam hai (Women are powerful, we are no less than others. We, too, have strength)."

While acknowledging the

progress made in advancing women's status, she said several obstacles still remain in ensuring their equal participation in society. "These challenges cannot be resolved by law alone. It is necessary to change our mindset," she said.

Murmu stressed the need for equality within families as well, saying parents should not discriminate between daughters and sons. She also said mothers-in-law should treat daughters-in-law as their own daughters.

The President also congratulated the ministry for organising the "Shakti Walk - SheLeadsBharat" from India Gate to Vijay Chowk as part of the celebrations, and praised the dedication of women from across the country who participated in the event.

Murmu also expressed satisfaction that the government has taken several steps to prioritise women's empowerment, highlighting programmes such as Beti Bachao Beti Padhao, Sukanya Samridhi Yojana, Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana, Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana and Mission Shakti.

NCB busts darknet drugs trafficking network, two held

Officials seize 'large' quantity of contraband

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) on Sunday said it has busted a darknet-based drugs trafficking network, which used to operate under the code name "Team Kalki", with the arrest of two persons and seizure of a "large" quantity of contraband.

The syndicate had been operating on darknet marketplaces and the Session app since January 2025. Acting on intelligence, the NCB launched an operation in the national capital and apprehended two key accused over the past three months.

NCB officials seized 2,338 LSD blotters, 160 MDMA pills weighing 77.517 grams, 73.612 grams of charas, 3.642 grams of amphetamines, and 3.6 kilograms of liquid MDMA. They were found hidden in 13 locally sourced parcels, as well as two parcels from the Netherlands.

According to the investigation, the darknet-based "Team Kalki" was run by Anurag Thakur and his associate, Vikas Rathi. Both of these individuals are known to be repeat offenders. They were previously arrested for the same crime but managed to escape punishment. While Rathi was arrested in a charas trafficking case filed by the Delhi Police's Special Cell, Anurag was arrested in a methamphetamine trafficking case filed by the Delhi Police's Crime Branch. They met each other at the prison and went on to start the darknet-based drug trade.

Initial indications are that the gang first operated on the dark net forum "Dread", with a vendor account that had a four-star rating. This means that they had carried out multiple successful transactions. They then



moved to the Session app to take orders from their clients.

Initial indications are that the gang had a nationwide network with advanced counter-detection mechanisms. The culprits allegedly got their supply of LSD and MDMA from international suppliers on the dark net from the Netherlands, Poland, and Germany.

Customers from across the country would place orders through the encrypted platforms. The culprits would then package the drugs and send them through courier services or the Speed Post. The culprits allegedly used the "dead drop" method in the Delhi area to send the drugs. In this method, the drugs were left at a pre-arranged location for collection.

It is believed that the nationwide network could have dispatched over 1,000 consignments since January 2025. A device collection and a cryptocurrency wallet allegedly belonging to the culprits were seized. The culprits allegedly used Monero and USDT to make the payments.

The NCB announced that further investigations were underway to identify the associates of the culprits.

Women's Day celebrated with enthusiasm at RCF Kapurthala

MPOST BUREAU

KAPURTHALA: A special programme, marking International Women's Day, was organised at the Rail Coach Factory (RCF), Kapurthala, in accordance with the instructions of the Railway Board. The objective of the programme was to highlight the achievements of women and promote gender equality in society.

During the programme, the remarkable achievements of women in various fields were highlighted, and the message was conveyed that the full and active participation of women in nation-building is extremely important.

On the occasion, Lalita Ramalingam, Principal Chief Medical Officer, and Renu



Pushkar Chhibber, Principal Chief Security Commissioner, participated as special speakers and shared their inspiring thoughts. They emphasised the importance of women's health, safety, self-reliance and equal opportunities at the workplace.

A special health & well-being camp was also organised, keeping in view the health and welfare of women employees. A large number of women

employees participated in the camp and availed themselves of health check-ups and medical consultations.

As part of the programme, a discussion session was also organised in which women employees enthusiastically participated and expressed their views on important issues such as women's empowerment, equal opportunities and the role of women in society.

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Sunday announced that industries providing employment opportunities to women in the state will receive additional subsidies from the government as part of efforts to boost women's economic participation.

Addressing a state-level function in Sirsa on the occasion of International Women's Day, Saini also launched the Haryana chapter of the Mahila Udyamita Manch, aimed at promoting women-led entrepreneurship in the state.

During the event, the chief minister transferred Rs 200.77 crore as the fifth instalment under the Deen Dayal Lado



Haryana CM Nayab Singh Saini, with minister Shruti Choudhry and MLH Gokul Setia, lights the traditional lamp during the state-level function to mark Women's Day in Sirsa on Sunday

Lakshmi Yojana, Rs 1,338.61 crore under various social security schemes, and Rs 20.21 crore under the Har Ghar-Har Grihini scheme directly into the bank accounts of eligible women. He also distributed seed money cheques worth Rs 3 crore to support startups and

assistance cheques to 16 women entrepreneurs.

Saini said Haryana was also marking 11 years of the Beti Bachao Beti Padhao campaign, launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi from Panipat in 2015. He said the state's sex ratio has improved from 871 in 2014 to 923 now, reflecting changing attitudes towards the girl child.

The chief minister said the Mahila Udyamita Manch would familiarise women with modern technologies and marketing strategies and help increase the number of women-led startups. The government has also proposed a Rs 5-crore Workplace Safety Fund, along with the creation of a POSH Cell and a Vishakha Portal to ensure safer workplaces for women.

CM ANNOUNCES Rs 5 LAKH AID

Jind: 4 women workers killed in factory fire

SWATI MAHAJAN

CHANDIGARH: At least four women workers died of suffocation and 12 others were injured after a fire broke out at a factory in Safidon in Jind district of Haryana on Saturday, officials said.

The deceased were identified as Pinki (45), Pooja (27), Usha (45) and Guddi (52). The factory, located in Bhaat Colony, manufactured Holi colours and was allegedly operating illegally, police said. Most of the injured workers were women.

According to officials, the fire reportedly started due to a short circuit near the main gate and quickly spread through the premises. It was alleged that the factory's main gate had been locked from the outside, making it difficult for workers to

CLOSER LOOK

- » The deceased were identified as Pinki (45), Pooja (27), Usha (45) and Guddi (52)
- » The factory, located in Bhaat Colony, manufactured Holi colours and was allegedly operating illegally
- » At least 12 other workers were injured. Most of

them are women

- » The fire reportedly started due to a short circuit near the main gate and quickly spread through the premises
- » It was alleged that the factory's main gate had been locked from the outside, making it difficult for workers to escape as smoke and flames engulfed the building

escape as smoke and flames engulfed the building.

As panic spread, some workers ran to the top floor while others hid inside rooms. A few reportedly jumped from the roof to raise an alarm and seek help.

Local residents rushed

Officials said two women died on the spot due to severe burn injuries and suffocation, while two others succumbed later during treatment.

Deputy Commissioner Mohammed Imran Raza said authorities would investigate allegations that the factory was operating illegally and examine claims of labour exploitation, including long working hours and low wages.

Meanwhile, Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini expressed grief over the incident and announced financial assistance of Rs 5 lakh for the families of each deceased worker and Rs 2 lakh for those injured.

He also directed the district administration to conduct a detailed probe to determine the cause of the fire and ensure steps are taken to prevent similar incidents in the future.

Haryana Chief Minister attends Hola Mohalla programme in Sirsa

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Sunday attended a Hola Mohalla programme at the Namdhari Gurdwara in Sirsa's Jiwan Nagar and sought blessings from members of the Sant Samaj.

Addressing a gathering of Namdhari devotees from India and abroad, Saini said he was happy to be present at the celebration and paid respects to Sant Dilip Singh Ji Maharaj.

He said saints were playing an important role in connecting society through love, service, brotherhood and spirituality.

The chief minister said Sirsa has long been associated with saints and spiritual traditions.

He said the first Sikh Guru, Guru Nanak Dev, visited the area in 1507 and the Gurdwara Sri Chilla Sahib was later established there.

Saini said saints such as Baba Sarsai Nath and Baba Bhooman Shah spread the message of spirituality, service and humanity from the region and their teachings continue to guide society.

He said Hola Mohalla symbolises courage, devotion and social harmony and reflects India's rich spiritual and cultural traditions.

The festival was started by the tenth Sikh Guru, Guru Gobind Singh, to strengthen the traditions of the Khalsa and promote unity and brotherhood.

The chief minister said the history of the Namdhari community is marked by sacrifice and dedication.

Referring to the Kuka Movement led by Satguru Ram Singh, he said it played an important role during India's freedom struggle.

He said the Namdhari community promoted the message of Swadeshi and boycott of foreign goods during the colonial period, which helped strengthen the freedom movement.

He also paid tribute to Namdhari martyrs who sacrificed their lives at Malerkotla but did not abandon the path of truth and self-respect.

Women's Day: NCC cadets distribute books at Kolkata slum

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: Following the motto of International Women's Day, 'Give to Gain', cadets from the 2 Bengal Naval Unit NCC, under the NCC West Bengal and Sikkim Directorate, observed the occasion on Sunday by visiting the NGO Humanity for You & Me (HUM) and distributing books to underprivileged girl children.

The event took place in the Tiljala slum area of Kolkata to recognise, encourage, and empower women and young girls from disadvantaged backgrounds. Through interactions with the local community, the cadets inspired young girls and women to recognise that education is the most powerful tool for empowerment.

Commander Mrinmoy



Ghosh, the Commanding Officer of the 2 Bengal Naval Unit NCC at Rabindra Sarobar, Kolkata, praised the women present, ages ranging from 5 to 60. He highlighted the crucial role women play in family development, instilling good values,

and contributing to society's progress. He stressed that empowering women is essential for the overall development of society.

Alongside CTO Artrica Dubey, the naval cadets engaged with the women at the event. She lauded their unwavering love, dedication, and sacrifices for their families, emphasising the importance of prioritising children's education—especially that of girls—and giving them the chance to attend school and chase their dreams.

During the outreach, cadets distributed various educational materials such as alphabet books, rhyme books, mathematics guides, and general knowledge resources. The goal was to promote early learning and foster a love of education from a young age.

India-Pakistan 1965 war hero KG George passes away at 95 in Kerala

'Lance Havildar George displayed courage and devotion to duty of a high order'

NEW DELHI: Lance Havildar K G George (retd), who was awarded a Vir Chakra for his heroics in the 1965 India-Pakistan War, passed away in Kerala at the age of 95, his family said on Sunday.

"My grandfather died early morning on Saturday. He was born in February 1931, and had fought in the 1965 Indo-Pak War," his grandson Remo John said.

He was born in Kerala and died at his residence in Kottayam due to age-related factors, John, 21, said.

George had served in the Indian Army's Corp of Signals, a key unit that was established in 1911.

Since its inception on February 15, 1911, Corps of Signals has transformed the communications of the Indian Army and also kept pace with the digital revolution witnessed in the 21st century.

The citation for his Vir Chakra describes his gallant act during the 1965 War and reads that he "displayed courage and devotion to duty of a high order".



An archival picture of 1965 War hero Lance Havildar K G George (Retd)

"During the period from the 6th till the 10th September 1965, under persistent enemy shelling and air strafing, Lance Havildar (Lineman Field) K G George continued to lead his section to restore disrupted communications in the Wagah Sector in Pakistan," it says.

"On the night of the September 8 and 9, 1965, notwithstanding risk to his life, he established a line of communication from Brigade Headquarters to the forward battalions during an enemy attack. In doing so L/Hav K. G. George displayed courage and devotion to duty of a high order and was awarded Vir Chakra," the citation reads.

His grandson, John, who is currently in Kottayam, said, the family in Kerala is awaiting arrival of "my father and my brother, who are currently

KEY POINTS

- » Lance Havildar K G George (retd) was awarded a Vir Chakra for his heroics in the 1965 India-Pakistan War
- » He was born in Kerala and died at his residence in Kottayam due to age-related factors
- » George had served in the Indian Army's Corp of Signals, a key unit that was established in 1911
- » The citation for his Vir Chakra describes his gallant act during the 1965 War and reads that he 'displayed courage and devotion to duty of a high order'

ward battalions during an enemy attack. In doing so L/Hav K. G. George displayed courage and devotion to duty of a high order and was awarded Vir Chakra," the citation reads.

His grandson, John, who is currently in Kottayam, said, the family in Kerala is awaiting arrival of "my father and my brother, who are currently

in Dubai".

"Due to the ongoing conflict in West Asia, they have not been able to travel out of Dubai so far, but they are expected to be back in India by Tuesday. Meanwhile, we have got our grandfather's mortal remains embalmed and preserved in a local mortuary," he said. The funeral services and burial will take place in Kottayam after their return to Kerala from Dubai, the grandson said.

AGENCIES

Nation Briefs

KERALA: 2 KILLED AFTER SHIP RAMS FISHING BOAT

KOCHI: Two crew members of a fishing boat have been killed after a ship rammed their vessel off the Kollam coast, police officials said on Sunday. The bodies of the deceased were recovered by the coast guard and will be brought to Vizhinjam on Monday, the coastal police said. The fishing boat, St Joseph, had 11 crew members, all from other states, and was engaged in deep-sea fishing. The vessel had left Shaktikulangara harbour in Kollam on Friday. The accident occurred on Saturday when the boat was anchored for fishing, and the ship, MT Solis, rammed into it about 120 nautical miles off the coast.

UP: CLERIC BEATEN BY MOB, 5 BOOKED

MUZAFFARNAGAR: A 28-year-old cleric was allegedly assaulted by a group of men in the Sarwat locality under the Civil Lines Police Station area here on Sunday, police said. Mufti Abdul Wahab was on his way to a mosque to pray when he came under an attack, they said. Circle Officer Siddharth Mishra said a case has been registered against Lavi, Basant, Harish, Aditya, and Rishabh in connection with the attack. The police have arrested Lavi while efforts are underway to trace the remaining accused. According to a complaint, Wahab was on his way to the mosque on his motorcycle when a group of men allegedly stopped him, made objectionable remarks and asked his name before assaulting him with sticks and a bat. The cleric was first taken to the district hospital and was referred to a higher medical centre due to his critical condition, the police said.



EDITORIAL
GUARDING
DIGITAL TRUST

India's digital payments revolution has been one of the most striking transformations in the country's economic landscape over the past decade. From the ubiquity of Unified Payments Interface (UPI) transactions to the proliferation of mobile wallets and instant banking services, India today processes billions of digital payments every month. This rapid adoption has brought convenience, financial inclusion and transparency into everyday transactions. However, it has also opened new avenues for cyber fraud and digital deception. Against this backdrop, the Reserve Bank of India's proposal to create a framework for compensating victims of small-value digital payment fraud marks an important intervention. By suggesting that banks, customers and the regulator share responsibility for such losses, the central bank appears to be acknowledging a fundamental reality: in an increasingly digital financial ecosystem, trust must be protected as vigorously as technology itself.

The proposed framework is significant because it addresses a grey area that has long troubled consumers. Digital payment frauds—often involving phishing links, fake customer care numbers, malicious apps, or social engineering tactics—frequently result in relatively small but distressing losses for individuals. Under existing rules, compensation is typically available when a customer reports the fraud promptly and demonstrates that the bank's systems failed. However, in many real-life situations, customers inadvertently reveal information or click on deceptive links, leading banks to deny compensation on the grounds of customer negligence. RBI's proposal seeks to soften this rigid approach by allowing partial reimbursement even when the customer is partly responsible. This acknowledges that fraudsters exploit human behaviour as much as technological vulnerabilities, and that the burden of safeguarding digital payments cannot rest solely on the consumer.

The proposal also introduces a capped, one-time reimbursement for such cases, indicating that the regulator wants to strike a balance between consumer protection and moral hazard. If compensation were unlimited or automatic, it could encourage reckless behaviour among users or create unsustainable financial exposure for banks. By limiting the benefit to small-value transactions and restricting it to a one-time claim, RBI appears to be sending a dual message. On one hand, customers deserve some protection when they fall victim to sophisticated fraud schemes; on the other, individuals must continue to exercise caution when using digital financial services. This approach reflects a pragmatic understanding of how digital fraud operates. Many scams rely on urgency, fear or confusion—tactics that can deceive even reasonably careful users. Providing partial compensation in such circumstances helps restore consumer confidence without undermining personal responsibility.

Another crucial dimension of the framework is the idea of shared liability. Traditionally, fraud losses have often been framed as a binary issue: either the bank is at fault or the customer is. RBI's proposal shifts this conversation toward a more nuanced model in which the burden is distributed among the financial institution, the consumer and the regulatory system. Banks may be required to contribute to compensation pools or absorb part of the losses, encouraging them to strengthen fraud detection systems and customer awareness campaigns. Customers, meanwhile, remain responsible for adhering to basic security practices such as safeguarding passwords and verifying payment requests. The regulator's role would involve defining the rules, monitoring compliance and ensuring that compensation mechanisms are transparent and fair. In effect, the framework attempts to create a cooperative defence against fraud rather than relying on blame after the damage is done.

The timing of this proposal is particularly important. India's digital payments ecosystem is expanding at an extraordinary pace, and with that growth comes an inevitable rise in cybercrime targeting ordinary users. Fraudsters constantly adapt their techniques, often staying one step ahead of awareness campaigns and technological safeguards. For a country where millions of new users are entering the digital financial system each year—many of them first-time participants with limited exposure to cyber risks—the psychological impact of fraud can be significant. Even a small financial loss can undermine trust in digital platforms, pushing users back toward cash transactions. RBI's proposal recognises that maintaining public confidence is as important as preventing fraud itself. A fair and transparent compensation framework can reassure users that the system will not abandon them when things go wrong.

Ultimately, the success of this initiative will depend on how the framework is designed and implemented. Clear eligibility criteria, swift dispute resolution and transparent reporting mechanisms will be essential. Banks will need to upgrade fraud monitoring tools and improve customer education, while regulators must ensure that compensation rules are consistently applied across institutions. At the same time, digital literacy campaigns must continue so that users understand the risks and responsibilities that accompany convenience. If executed thoughtfully, the RBI's proposal could become a cornerstone of India's digital finance architecture—one that balances innovation with accountability. In a country racing toward a cash-light economy, safeguarding the trust of millions of users is not merely a regulatory concern; it is the foundation on which the future of digital banking will stand.

TALKING
SHOP



RAJEEV NARAYAN

THE WRITER
IS A VETERAN
JOURNALIST AND
COMMUNICATIONS
SPECIALIST

Time is an unequal resource. The poor lose it waiting for buses; the middle class loses it in chaotic traffic; entrepreneurs lose it on mere approvals; and patients lose time accessing healthcare. Time poverty is economic poverty

STRATEGIC
PULSE



SHANTANU MUKHARJI

THE WRITER IS
A RETIRED IPS
OFFICER, ADVISER
NATSTRAT, AND A
FORMER NATIONAL
SECURITY ADVISOR
IN MAURITIUS

Pakistan's growing diplomatic, economic and cultural outreach to Bangladesh seeks to reshape regional ties, but memories of 1971 ensure Dhaka's response will be closely watched

India's Time Theft

Indian cities are not merely congested; they are structurally inefficient in ways that silently erode human productivity, health, family life and economic output

"A man who dares to waste one hour of time has not discovered the value of life."
— Charles Darwin

Time is the most unequal public resource. The poor lose time waiting for buses, the middle class loses time in traffic, small entrepreneurs lose time navigating approvals, and patients lose time accessing healthcare. Time poverty is economic poverty. Consider commutes of two to three hours every day, poor last-mile connectivity, unplanned construction and the infuriatingly reactive and unpredictable urban governance. All of these impose a hidden 'time tax' on crores of Indians, every day.

Think of the mornings stolen. Imagine that young executive in Gurugram who checks her navigation app at 8:17 am. The screen flashes red. What should be a 14-km commute to Cyber City will take 78 minutes, she learns. She will leave home before her child wakes up and return after dinner is cleared. At the same moment in Delhi, a trader on his Scooty has already lost 45 minutes waiting for a municipal approval counter to open. And at that very same moment, a tech employee in Bengaluru has factored in two hours of traffic into his workday, planning life not around meetings but around bottlenecks.

None of this appears in GDP tables. Yet, this daily surrender of time—to congestion, administrative friction, unreliable transport and fragmented planning—is among the most corrosive inefficiencies in India's growth story. India is not just traffic-heavy. It is time-inefficient too. And time, unlike money, cannot be recapitalised.

A Congestion Economy
The scale of the loss is staggering. An analysis by TomTom ranked Bengaluru among the world's most congested cities, with commuters losing over 250 hours annually to traffic delays. Mumbai and Pune consistently feature in similar global congestion indices. Even cities like Delhi, which that have invested heavily in metro systems, continue to see private vehicle growth outpace public transport expansion.

The economic cost is not abstract. The World Bank has warned that urban congestion in developing economies can shave many percentage points off productivity by inflating logistics costs, reducing labour mobility and increasing fuel consumption. For India, where urban areas contribute more than 60 per cent of GDP while occupying a fraction of the landmass, inefficiency in cities translates directly into national underperformance. Yet, the policy response remains fragmented. Flyovers



India's demographic dividend depends not only on the number of workers, but on how efficiently their hours are deployed

here, signal recalibration there, piecemeal road widening elsewhere. Rarely does anyone ask the kernel question: How many hours are Indian citizens losing annually, and what is that time worth? If time were priced, the numbers would be physically explosive.

Urban time loss is not evenly distributed. The affluent can move closer to business districts, outsource domestic chores or work remotely. The poor and lower classes endure the longest commutes, the slowest buses and the most bureaucratic friction. A factory worker may spend three hours daily in transit because affordable housing lies far from employment hubs. Informal workers often queue for basic documentation, healthcare access or utility connections. These are hours lost not to productivity, but to administrative inertia.

Governance Sans Clocks
As a nation, India measures income inequality obsessively. But does it measure time inequality? No. Not at all. If two citizens earn the same salary but one sacrifices four additional hours daily to commute and procedural delays, their lived economic realities diverge sharply. Lost time erodes family life, eats away into rest, undermines health and limits upskilling opportunities. Silently, it compounds.

India's urban governance architecture was not designed for the scale and density it is being forced to manage. Metropolises sprawl across multiple municipal corporations, development authorities and transport agencies with overlapping mandates and little coordination. Decision cycles stretch across months. Project clearances crawl through layered approvals. The result is systemic drag.

Contrast this with cities like Singapore, where integrated land-use and transport planning cuts average commute times greatly. Or Seoul, which has implemented intelligent traffic systems that adjust flows in real time. These cities treat time efficiency as a policy objective, not a by-product. India rarely does. Even programmes such as the Smart Cities Mission have often prioritised infrastructure visibility over measurable reductions in citizen time and life-quality loss. Beautification and digital dashboards matter, but do they shorten commutes? Reduce queuing hours? Compress approval timelines?

Without explicit time-reduction targets, inefficiency continues unchanged.

Hidden GDP Loss
Consider the arithmetic. If 5 crore urban commuters lose an average of 90 minutes daily to congestion and procedural friction, that adds up to 7.5 crore hours per day, or over 2,700 crore hours in a single year. Even valuing that time conservatively at Rs 150 per hour yields an economic loss exceeding Rs 4 lakh crore a year. These are only illustrative estimates. But they reveal the order of magnitude.

Beyond direct productivity loss lie secondary costs: higher fuel imports, increased vehicular emissions, stress-related health burdens and reduced female labour participation due to unsafe or time-intensive travel. Urban inefficiency becomes a drag on climate goals, public health and gender equity; all of it simultaneously. India cannot aspire to be the world's third-largest economy while tolerating first-world congestion and developing-world governance speed.

If time theft is structural, reform must be systemic. In an ideal India, a dreamer would want states to publish annual 'Citizen Time Accounts'—audited estimates of commute duration, service delivery timelines and procedural turnaround periods. For what gets measured can get managed. Further, urban funding from the Centre could be partially tied to measurable reductions in commute times and service delays. Just as fiscal deficits are monitored, so too should urban time deficits. Again, integrated metropolitan transport authorities must be empowered with fiscal and planning autonomy. Agencies that work in a fragmented chaos cannot solve networked congestion.

You want more dream solutions, we could make land-use reform non-negotiable. Mixed-use zoning, higher density near traffic corridors and affordable housing within employment clusters would reduce travel demand significantly, and not just cosmetically. Digital governance must shift from mere portal creation to process compression. A service that moves online but still needs physical verification has not saved time; it has only relocated inconvenience. Finally, urban policy must centre pedestrian and public transport primacy. Every additional private vehicle is a congestion-multiplier. Cities that push buses, metros and non-motorised transport can reclaim hours.

From Growth to Dignity
The moral dimension of 'time theft' has never been articulated. But when a nation's citizens routinely lose three to four waking hours every day navigating inefficiency, growth statistics ring hollow. Time lost is childhood missed, health compromised, skills unacquired and relationships strained. Economic ambition without time discipline is unsustainable.

India's demographic dividend depends not only on the number of workers, but on how efficiently their hours are deployed. A country that wastes hundreds of productive hours annually undercuts its own demographic advantage. Reclaiming time is thus not cosmetic reform; it is structural nation-building.

If India can build highways at record speed and digitise payments at global scale, it can surely design cities that respect the finite hours of their residents. The question is whether policymakers will elevate time-efficiency from an afterthought to a core performance metric. Growth must not be measured only in rupees generated, but in hours redeemed. Because the most unequal public resource in India today is not income, land or capital. It is time.

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Is Pakistan wooing Bangladesh?

Pakistan intensifies diplomatic, cultural and economic outreach to Bangladesh, raising questions about regional alignments, historical memory and Dhaka's evolving foreign policy priorities

There are incessant overtures on the part of Pakistan to woo Bangladesh. This process had vigorously begun soon after the interim government was in place in Dhaka in the aftermath of Hasina's downfall in early August 2024. Then, the government under Yunus saw a series of exchanges of visits between Pakistan and Bangladesh, including high-level military delegations, massive concessions in customs and excise duties on both sides, relaxations of visa policies, as well as restoration of direct air links, including to and from Karachi and Dhaka. Apart from this, Bangladesh also saw an attempt by some forces to resurrect Mohd Ali Jinnah, who was a sworn Bangla hater and promoter of Urdu, causing massive anti-Urdu violent agitation in the early 1950s. To expand further, Dhaka recently witnessed a programme commemorating Jinnah on his 76th death anniversary, with active participation by local Bangladesh High Commission officials.

The above was unprecedented in Bangladesh, and not only that, but there were also visible attempts on the part of some pro-Pakistan elements who tried to name one of the university hostels after Allama Iqbal, a move hitherto not seen in Bangladesh. Simultaneously, there were well-organised attempts to vandalise Tagore's ancestral properties as well as targeting film icon Satyajit Ray's grandfather's house. These were not routine and bore footprints of possibly subtle Pakistani designs to bring both the countries together by reviving Jinnah, the founder of Pakistan, as well as the decimation of the original Indian culture, which has always been the bulwark of Bangladesh. Besides these, the erstwhile head of the interim government, Muhammad Yunus, met the Pakistani Prime Minister more than once at different fora, and a clear bonhomie was spotted. This perhaps happened because soon after Hasina's exit, there was a strong anti-India sentiment prevailing in Bangladesh, when the political dispensation, media and a large section of people seemed to be hostile.



Islamabad's renewed engagement with Dhaka signals changing strategic equations in South Asia

Now, with Tarique Rahman as the new Prime Minister, we see that the Pakistani government has extended an invitation to visit Pakistan for its Independence Day celebrations and witness the Pakistan Day Parade. While a formal nod is still awaited, the Secretary General of the ruling Pakistan Muslim League (PML-N), Professor Ahsan Iqbal Chaudhary, who attended the oath ceremony (February 17) of Tarique Rahman, renewed the invitation to him on behalf of Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif to visit Pakistan at the earliest. The invite was believed to have been accepted by the Bangladeshi leader. Bangladesh High Commissioner in Islamabad Muhammad Iqbal Hussain Khan also maintained that the government and people of Pakistan are keen to further strengthen ties between the two "brotherly" countries. This is a clear indication that the wooing continues.

Optimists also assess that, as two of the most populous economies in South Asia, Pakistan and Bangladesh stand to benefit greatly from increased coordination. Both nations possess growing consumer markets, expanding industrial bases and ambitious development agendas. Enhanced trade between them might open new opportunities for exporters, investors and entrepreneurs. Improved connectivity—whether

maritime, digital or commercial—can reduce costs and increase market access both ways.

Bangladeshi watchers are also hopeful that, alongside economic collaboration, people-to-people contact will be crucial in strengthening ties. Cultural exchanges, academic partnerships and tourism initiatives can build familiarity and goodwill between the citizens of both nations. Expanding educational scholarships and research partnerships would not only enhance knowledge sharing but also reinforce long-term institutional connections. This seems to be another indicator that Pakistan is relentlessly pursuing its overtures, though the hopes could be misplaced.

The invitation extended to Prime Minister Tarique Rahman appears to be more than symbolic. It also perhaps represents an opportunity to chart a new phase of engagement characterised by economic pragmatism, youth empowerment and regional connectivity. Through shared development aspirations and practical cooperation, both governments can translate diplomatic goodwill into tangible progress—at least this is hoped for by Pakistan and a section in Bangladesh.

In the meantime, according to some analysts, as South Asia navigates a shifting global economic landscape and

evolving geopolitical dynamics, constructive intra-regional relations are becoming increasingly important. Pakistan's outreach to Bangladesh reflects an understanding that long-term stability and prosperity are unattainable without sustained dialogue and cooperation. If high-level engagement continues and mutual development remains a shared objective, Pakistan and Bangladesh can build a durable and mutually beneficial partnership that advances their national goals while contributing to the progress of the wider region. This is certainly optimistic, yet it needs very careful study while exercising abundant caution.

Further, Islamabad is believed to have allocated 500 scholarships for Bangladeshi students, with 75 already travelling to Pakistan for higher education, and has proposed closer coordination between national data and statistics institutions in both countries. Pakistan is also pushing Bangladesh to hold joint celebrations to mark the 150th birth anniversary of poet Allama Iqbal. This is yet another move by Pakistan to bring Bangladesh into its cultural fold in the name of cultural and literary exchanges.

Meanwhile, Bangladeshi and Pakistani watchers are intently waiting for the outcome of the decision on the part of Tarique Rahman on whether he undertakes the visit to Pakistan to attend the latter's Independence Day celebrations in Islamabad. As is known, the new Bangladesh Prime Minister has decided to visit Bhutan as his first external trip after taking over the high office. If at all he goes to Pakistan before India, it would mean that the Pakistani overtures to Bangladesh have been squarely responded to and one can safely assume that both the countries are now on a path to restore impaired bilateral relations. However, a majority of Bangladeshis are yet to forget the Pakistani atrocities on Bengalis in the run-up to the liberation struggle, which also saw a genocide for which Pakistan has not yet tendered an apology despite repeated calls by Bangladesh for nearly 55 years.

Views expressed are personal

Russia says international law effectively dead, calls for UNSC P-5 summit

MOSCOW: Russia has said international law is effectively dead amid escalating tensions in West Asia following the US-Israeli strike on Iran, and called for reviving President Vladimir Putin's proposal to convene a summit of the five permanent members of the UN Security Council. Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov said the current global situation underscores the need to revisit Putin's proposal, first made before the COVID-19 pandemic, for a summit of the P-5 -- Russia, the US, China, France and the UK -- to discuss global security and stability. "We have all lost what we call international law... I don't even understand how anyone can be called upon to follow the norms and principles of international law. It effectively no longer exists," Peskov said in an interview with the state-run Rossiya TV. He said international law exists "de jure" (by law) but no longer "de facto" (in fact). "We cannot tell anyone to follow international law, follow which law? Nobody can formulate today what it is," he said. Referring to the sharp escalation following the US-Israeli attack on Iran, Peskov said the situation in the region has become significantly destabilised. "The region has become significantly destabilised, and the cumulative effect of the vast number of regional conflicts and unresolved issues is resulting in both economic and political consequences," he said. Meanwhile, Russian Foreign Minister Sergei Lavrov said the US should clarify its broader plans and explain how they relate to existing international norms.

NEPAL ELECTIONS

Balendra Shah's RSP makes history with landmark win

KATHMANDU: The RSP led by young rapper-turned-politician Balendra Shah 'Balen' was on Sunday headed towards a spectacular victory with over two-thirds seats in general elections that saw the legacy parties face rout at the hustings in Nepal. Formed in 2022, the Rashtriya Swatantra Party (RSP) won 122 of the 165 directly elected seats in the House of Representative elections, according to the Election Commission (EC). The EC has announced results for 159 of the 165 seats as of 8:30 pm. Results for six seats remain to be declared, the EC said, adding, the counting that had started on Thursday soon after voting ended will conclude by Monday afternoon for direct seats. On Saturday, RSP's 35-year-old prime-ministerial candidate Balen defeated four-time prime minister K P Sharma Oli, the chair of Nepal's one of the largest parties -- CPN-UML -- by a huge margin of about 50,000 votes in the Jhapa-5 constituency. Balen is expected to be the next prime minister of Nepal, reflecting a public mood of rejection of established parties. He will be the first Madhesi prime minister of the Himalayan nation and also the youngest to occupy the top post in the country's parliamentary history. The Nepali Congress (NC) is a distant second, winning 17 seats while the CPN-(UML) of ousted prime minister Oli won just eight seats and is leading in two constituencies. The Nepal Communist



Balendra Shah (right), Prime Ministerial candidate of the Rashtriya Swatantra Party (RSP) from Jhapa Constituency-5, at the Election Commission premises after winning the constituency in the Nepal general elections

Highlights

» EC has announced results for 156 of 165 seats as of 5:30 pm

» Balen is expected to be the next prime minister of Nepal

» Rana Magar won by a huge margin of 48,742 votes against Ghimire

LEGACY PARTIES FAILED TO CONVINCE VOTERS

Party (NCP) won seven seats, the Shram Sanskriti Party won three while the Rashtriya Prajatantra Party (RPP) won one seat, the EC data showed. Among the winners is one

independent. Independent candidate Mahabir Pun, who had resigned as education minister in the interim government, won in Myagdi-1 constituency in remote mountain districts beating his nearest rivals from the CPN-(UML) and the NC. The RSP had not fielded any candidate against him. The seats won by RSP, headed by Ravi Lamichhane, include a clean sweep of all 15 constituencies of three districts in Kathmandu Valley. RSP chairman Lamichhane won with a huge margin from the Chitwan-2 constituency, marking his third consecutive victory, with 54,402 votes against his nearest rival, NC's Mina Kumari Kharel getting only 14,564 votes.

Gen Z probe body submits its report to Nepal government

KATHMANDU: A high-level commission to probe the killings, arson and damages during the Gen Z protests in September last year submitted its report to Nepal's interim government on Sunday, blaming lack of good governance and inefficiency by the then administration. As the probe report was submitted to the interim Prime Minister Sushila Karki at the PM Office at Singhdurbar, neither the commission chief nor the government released any names of persons responsible for shooting at Gen Z protesters and other related issues. A total of 76 people were killed during the two day protest -- 22 youths on September 8 while 54 others on the next day. A week after Sushila Karki took over as the interim prime minister, a decision by the cabinet on September 21 led to the formation of the judicial inquiry commission led by former Supreme Court justice



Representational Image

Gauri Bahadur Karki to probe into the incidents related to the September Gen Z protests. The incident occurred mainly due to lack of good governance and inefficiency shown by then government administration, chair of the commission, Gauri Bahadur Karki, said. People were frustrated due to politicisation of government

institutions, including bureaucracy and judicial bodies, he said. "Those involved in shooting the Gen Z youths and issuing orders as well as those who didn't act to stop the killings, have been recommended for legal action," chairman Karki told media persons after handing over the report without giving other details.

Pak: 583 Afghan Taliban operatives killed in ongoing border operation

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan's security forces have killed 583 Afghan Taliban operatives in the ongoing military operation launched along the border last month, according to an official data released on Sunday. Pakistan launched Operation Ghazab lil-Haq on Feb 26 after the Afghan Taliban attacked 53 locations along the border. Providing an update on social media, Information Minister Attaullah Tarar said the Taliban losses include "583 killed and 795 injured". He also said Pakistan destroyed 242 Taliban check posts during the ongoing

Pakistan launched Operation Ghazab lil-Haq on Feb 26

operation, while another 38 posts were captured and later on destroyed. Tarar said 213 Taliban tanks, armoured vehicles and artillery guns have been destroyed and 64 locations across Afghanistan have been "effectively targeted by air". Meanwhile, official sources said the armed forces thwarted an infiltration bid by three TTP terrorists in the Chaman border area.

At least 3 Palestinians killed in West Bank clash

ABU FALAH: Three Palestinians were killed in a violent clash with settlers in the Israeli-occupied West Bank on Sunday, bringing the number of Palestinians killed in recent days to six. The surge in violence comes as much of Israel and the world's attention is focused on the regional war with Iran. The Israeli military said it responded to reports of Israeli settlers attacking Palestinians near Khirbet Abu Falah, east of Ramallah. Two Palestinians were killed by gunfire and a third died from suffocation, likely due to tear gas, the military said. Two of the victims, Fare' Hamayel and Thaeer Hamayel, were cousins. The third man killed was Mohammad Murra. All three were buried in a joint funeral. Amin Shouman, a resident of Abu Falah who witnessed the attack, told The Associated Press that dozens of Israeli settlers approached the village from the north and opened fire when they were confronted by a community guard committee along the border of the village. In 2025, the United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs reported 240 Palestinians were killed in the territory, with the vast majority by Israel's military and nine attributed to Israeli settlers. Thus far this year, a far larger share of fatalities has been directly attributed to armed settlers. Sunday's fatalities followed several deadly incidents last week. One Palestinian was killed in the South Hebron Hills on Saturday by an Israeli reservist.

Trump grieves with families during return of soldiers killed in Middle East

Both Trump and Vance were present for the transfer

DOVER AIR FORCE BASE: President Donald Trump on Saturday joined grieving families at Dover Air Force Base at the dignified transfer for the six US soldiers killed in the war in the Middle East. The dignified transfer, a ritual that returns the remains of US service members killed in action, is considered one of the most sombre duties of any commander in chief. During his first term, Trump said bearing witness to the transfer was "the toughest thing I have to do" as president. "It is a very sad day," Trump told reporters on Air Force One as he returned to Florida later on Saturday afternoon, saying that he was "glad we paid our respects". He said the relatives of the deceased are "great people, great parents, wives, family" and said that the "parents



US President Donald Trump salutes as an Army carry team moves the flag-draped transfer case containing the remains of soldier

were so proud". Both Trump and Vice President J D Vance were present for the transfer, as were their spouses. A host of top administration officials were in attendance, including Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth, who wrote in a social media post

on Friday of "an unbreakable spirit to honour their memory and the resolve they embodied". Attorney General Pam Bondi, White House chief of staff Susie Wiles, special envoy Steve Witkoff and Tulsi Gabbard, the director of national intelligence.

TO HELP HIT US TARGETS

Trump downplays importance of Russia sharing intel with Iran

DORAL: President Donald Trump said on Saturday that it was inconsequential if Russia has provided Iran with information to help Tehran target US military personnel and assets in the Middle East as the week-old war rages. The president dismissed the import of such information-sharing after he attended the dignified transfer for six Army reservists who were killed in a drone strike in Kuwait the day after the US and Israel launched a war on Iran that has unsettled the global economy. Trump stopped short of confirming reports by The Associated Press and other news outlets that US intelligence officials believe Russia has provided Iran with such targeting information. But if Moscow is passing on such details, he said Iran was getting little out of it. "If you take a look at what has happened to Iran in the last week, if they are getting information, it is not helping them much," Trump told reporters



US President Donald Trump

on Air Force One as he flew to Miami, where he is spending the rest of the weekend. The president also waved off a question about how Russia assisting Iran in such a way might affect his view of the US-Russia relationship. "They would say we do it against them," Trump responded. "Wouldn't they say that we do it against them?" Ukraine, in the four years since it was invaded by Russia, has received US intelligence to help defend against incoming missiles from Russia as well as to help Kyiv hit certain Russian targets.

World Briefs

POLICE INVESTIGATE EXPLOSION OUTSIDE US EMBASSY IN OSLO

OSLO: Norwegian police are investigating an explosion outside the US Embassy in Oslo early Sunday, officials said. No injuries were reported. Police received reports of a "loud bang" or explosion around 1 am, Oslo police said in a news release. The explosion was caused by some sort of incendiary device, Oslo police representative Frode Larsen said during a news conference Sunday. Investigators believe the embassy was the target and are searching for the perpetrators and their motive. Local media reported minor damage to an entrance of the embassy, and people nearby said the street was blanketed in thick smoke following the blast. Police are seeking to talk to witnesses.

COLOMBIANS ELECTS NEW CONGRESS, CHOOSING PRESIDENTIAL CANDIDATES

BPGOTA: Colombians head to the polls on Sunday to elect a new Congress and select candidates from three major coalitions in a primary-style contest ahead of a presidential election this May. The election unfolds under high alert for political violence across the South American country, particularly in rural regions dominated by illegal armed groups. At the same time, President Gustavo Petro -- the nation's first left-leaning leader -- has cast doubt on the country's election software, pointing to the 2022 legislative elections, when his Historic Pact movement gained over 390,000 votes following a recount.

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Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower (s) and Guarantor (s) that the below described movable/ immovable property mortgaged/hypothecated charged to the Secured Creditor, the Symbolic Possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Canara Bank, will be sold on "As is where is" and "Whatever there is basis" on below mentioned dates through E-Auction under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, read with Rule 8(6) & 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. For detailed terms and conditions of the sale please refer the link "E-Auction" provided in provider (M/s PSB Alliance (Baanknet.com)), (Contact No. 8291220220, Email: support.BAANKNET@psballiance.com) or Canara Bank's website www.canarabank.com, EMD amount of 10% of the Reserve Price is to be deposited in E-Wallet of https://baanknet.com portal directly or by generating the Challan therein to deposit the EMD through RTGS/NEFT in the account details as mentioned in the said challan.

Name and Address Borrower/ Guarantor	Brief Description of Immovable Property	Total Liabilities (Rs.)	Date & Time of Auction
1. M/S SAMORA LIGHTS (BORROWER) ADD:- MPL NO. 1778, GROUND FLOOR BISSOMAL COLONY, BHAGIRATH PALACE, CHANDNI CHOWK, NEW DELHI-110006	All the part & parcel of Property bearing no H-34, half portion of plot measuring 75 sq. yds. (Out of total land 150 sq.yds) out of rectangle No. 29 killa no 22/2,23 & 24 Situated in the freehold approved residential colony known as Siri Nagar Extension Shakurbasti, New Delhi-110034	Reserve Price (Rs.) EMD (Rs.) Increment Amount (Rs.)	EMD Date Date of Visit Contact Person Name
2. Mrs. ANITA GUPTA W/O MANOJ KUMAR GUPTA (PROP.) ADD:- WZ 621, SRI NAGAR,SHAKUR BASTI, NEW DELHI-110034	Boundaries as per deed:- East:- House Built on Plot no.33 West:- Portion of the said Land North:- Gali 10 ft South:- Gali 15 ft	Rs. 12,83,384.80 as on 05.03.2026 Rs. 94,50,000/- Rs. 9,45,000/- Rs. 1,00,000/-	31.03.2026 between 12:30 PM TO 01:30 PM (With unlimited extensions of 5 minutes duration each) 30.03.2026 at 5.00 pm 30.03.2026 at 10.00 am to 5.00 pm
3. Mr. MANOJ KUMAR GUPTA (GUARANTOR) ADD:- WZ 621, SRI NAGAR, SHAKUR BASTI, NEW DELHI-110034			
4. Late. Mr. AMAR NATH GUPTA S/O SHRI KALU RAM (MORTGAGOR) ADD:- Block- H-34, SRI NAGAR, SHAKUR BASTI, NEW DELHI-110034 Through its Legal Heir, 5. Mr. MANOJ KUMAR GUPTA S/O Late. Shri AMAR NATH GUPTA ADD:- WZ 621, SRI NAGAR,SHAKUR BASTI, NEW DELHI-110034			

Date : 06.03.2026

Place : New Delhi

For Canara Bank Authorised Officer

सेन्ट्रल बैंक ऑफ इंडिया Central Bank of India

Regional Office Delhi (North) 1398, First Floor, Chandni Chowk, Delhi-110006

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE (Under SARFAESI Act 2002)

APPENDIX- IV-A (SEE PROVISIO TO RULE 8(6) SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES

E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the borrower(s) and guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged / charged to the Central Bank of India (secured creditor), the constructive/ physical Possession of which have been taken by the authorized officer of Central Bank of India(Secured creditors), will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on date 16.04.2026 for recovery of dues to the Central Bank of India from below mention Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s). The Reserve Price and Earnest money deposit (EMD) is displayed against the details of respective properties.

S. No.	Name of Branch	Authorised Officer / B.M.	Name of the Account	Description of Property & Owner Name	Demand Notice Date & Amount Dues (In Rupees)	Date & Type of Possession	In Rupees Reserve Price EMD Bid Increase
1.	Kaushambi Ghaziabad	Ms. Dipika Rana Mobile: 8800013550	Study Banker.Com (Prop. Reshma Jain)	Office No.-18, Third Floor, Tower B (Building Known as "The lthum") Plot No. A-40, Sector 62, Noida Uttar Pradesh Area-122.54 Sq Metre Owner- Shailendra Kumar Jain S/o Kesho Ram Jain	01.07.2024 Rs.46.01 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	04.10.2024 (Symbolic)	₹ 1,12,20,000.00 ₹ 11,22,000.00 ₹ 1,00,000.00

E-AUCTION DATE: 16.04.2026, TIME: 12:00 NOON TO 04:00 PM WITH AUTO EXTENSION OF 10 MINUTES

Last Date & Time of Submission of EMD and Documents (Online) On or Before: 16.04.2026 Upto 03:30 PM.

Bidder will register on website: https://BAANKNET.com and upload KYC documents and after verification of KYC documents by the service provider, EMD to be deposited in BAANKNET EMD wallet through NEFT/RTGS/Transfer / Generation of challan from (https://BAANKNET.com). The auction will be conducted through common landing platform BAANKNET.com Portal (https://BAANKNET.com). E-auction will be held "As is where is", "As is what is" and "whatever there is" basis. (All other charges/ dues to the property will be borne by the purchaser).

For detailed terms and conditions please refer to the link provided in www.centralbankofindia.co.in Secured Creditor or auction platform (https://BAANKNET.com). Helpdesk: (+91) 8291220220, E-mail: support.BAANKNET@psballiance.com

STATUTORY 30 DAY'S SALE NOTICE UNDER RULE 8(6) OF THE SARFAESI ACT, 2002

Borrowers/Guarantors/ Mortgagors are hereby notified to pay the sum as mentioned above along with upto date interest and ancillary expenses before the date of e-auction, failing which the property will be auctioned/sold and balance dues, if any, will be recovered with interest and cost.

DATE: 07.03.2026

Authorised Officer, CENTRAL BANK OF INDIA, RO Delhi (North), Delhi

Centre sets up 17-member panel for SEZ policy reforms

It will submit a concept paper or roadmap, suggestions or amendments within 6 months along with recommendations

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The government has set up a 17-member committee to suggest larger reforms in the policy for SEZs, an official said. It will submit a concept paper or roadmap or suggestions or amendments within six months along with its recommendations for broad-based and comprehensive reforms to formulate a SEZ 2.0 policy.

It will undertake a background study focused on the harmonisation of various prevalent export promotion schemes, including SEZs, export-oriented units (EoUs), MOOWR (Manufacturing and Other Operations in Warehouse), Advance Authorisation, EPCG (export promotion for capital goods), and Duty Free Import Authorisation (DFIA).

The committee's composition includes representatives from commerce, customs, Niti Aayog, Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), Central Board of Indirect Taxes & Customs (CBIC), Directorate General of Export Promotion, export promotion council for SEZs, two development commissioners, and Department of Economic Affairs.

The terms of reference



The terms of reference include examining the existing Special Economic Zones (SEZ) Act, 2005

include examining the existing Special Economic Zones (SEZ) Act, 2005, with a view to assessing their effectiveness in the current global trade, investment environment and macro-economic landscape and harmonisation with other export promotion schemes so that policy distortion, if any, may be addressed.

It will evaluate the impact of recent and proposed reforms in SEZ policy, including measures relating to Domestic Tariff Area (DTA) sales, fiscal and non-fiscal incentives, compliance requirements, and operational flexibilities, on exports, investment, employment and ease of

Highlights

- » It will study international best practices and comparable SEZ/free trade zone models and assess their adaptability to the Indian context
- » It will engage with key stakeholders, including center & state govts, SEZ authorities, developers, units, industry associations & exporters to obtain inputs

doing business.

It will also assess the effectiveness of SEZs in attracting domestic and foreign investment, promoting manufacturing generation, services, technology up-gradation, value addition, and employment, including for MSMEs.

The terms of reference also include identifying operational, procedural, and regulatory challenges faced by SEZ developers and units, including issues relating to customs, taxation, compliance burden, infrastructure, and coordination among stakeholders; and reviewing the fiscal impact of SEZs and related reforms on revenue including

foregone duties and taxes, and assess the cost-benefit outcomes in terms of exports, investment and economic activity.

Besides, it will study international best practices and comparable SEZ/free trade zone models and assess their adaptability to the Indian context; and engage with key stakeholders, including center and state governments, SEZ authorities, developers, units, industry associations, and exporters to obtain inputs. The committee will recommend short-term, medium-term and long-term policy, legal and procedural reforms, including possible amendments to the SEZ Act/Rules, and suggest an implementation roadmap with clear timelines.

The government in the Budget announced a one-time measure to allow SEZ units to sell their goods in the domestic market at concessional import duty rates, subject to certain quantitative restrictions.

It was a long-pending demand of these zones as they were not able to sell their excess production due to global uncertainties and high import duties in India on labour-intensive sectors. At present, goods coming from units in SEZs in the DTA or domestic market attract high import duties.

Women shaped my journey, says Gautam Adani on Int'l Women's Day

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Marking International Women's Day, Adani Group chairman Gautam Adani on Sunday paid tribute to the women who shaped his life and journey, saying the foundations of his success were built on the strength, values and support he drew from family.

Writing on LinkedIn, he reflected on the influence of his mother Shantaben Adani, recalling how stories from Indian epics such as the Ramayana during his childhood instilled values of courage, sacrifice and duty. He said he later understood the depth of those lessons when, at the age of 16, he left home for Mumbai to build his own career, recalling the strength it must have taken for his mother to allow him to step into an uncertain future.

Adani also acknowledged the role of his wife Priti Adani, who left a career in dentistry to lead the Adani Foundation, which he said now works across 22 states in India in areas including education, healthcare and livelihoods and has touched more than 10 million lives.

He praised daughters-in-law Paridhi Adani and Diva Adani for bringing "fresh perspectives and new energy" into the family, while also speaking about the joy his granddaughters bring into his life.

Reflecting on his business journey, Adani said that while entrepreneurs may spend decades building infrastructure and companies, the ulti-



Adani Group chairman Gautam Adani

mate purpose remains creating a future worthy of the next generation. "I have always lived between two worlds, work and family. And everything I have built in the first world was made possible because of the strength I draw from the second," he said. "The strongest foundations in life are not built with concrete or steel, but by the people who shape who we become."

Adani said the story of Kaushalya from Ramayana, narrated by his mother, has stayed with him. Kaushalya watched

her son, Lord Rama, give up the rights to his kingdom and leave Ayodhya to walk into exile for 14 years. "As a child I did not fully understand the depth of that sacrifice. I could not yet grasp what it meant for a mother to stand there and watch her son walk away into an uncertain future," he said adding many years later, he began to understand that moment differently.

At the age of 16, he left home for Mumbai with almost nothing in his pocket. "My mother let me go," he said. "A mother who had given her youngest child everything she could, and then found the courage to let him walk into the unknown."

Perhaps every Indian mother carries a little of Kaushalya within her, the quiet strength to let her child step away from the safety of home and into his own destiny, he

said. "If my mother gave me my values, my wife Priti has been the keeper of my conscience," Adani said. "When we got married, Priti was a qualified dentist with a promising career ahead of her. Yet she chose a very different path. She stepped away from her profession and in many ways from her own identity to dedicate her life to building the Adani Foundation."

What began as a small initiative has today touched over 10 million lives across 22 states of India spanning education, healthcare, sustainable livelihoods and community development. "Every evening when I return home after a long day at work, Priti typically has a story waiting. A story about a child whose future has changed. A farmer who now sees hope. A girl who stood up for what she believed in. A family that now has opportunity," he said.

WTO's Cameroon ministerial to discuss reforms, agriculture

NEW DELHI: Trade ministers from 166 countries are expected to discuss issues such as WTO reforms, agriculture, dispute settlement and the e-commerce moratorium during the four-day ministerial meeting of the World Trade Organization (WTO) in Yaounde, Cameroon, an official said. The 14th Ministerial Conference (MC14) of the WTO will be held from March 26 to 29, 2026. India's delegation will be led by Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal.

The meeting comes at a time when global trade has been disrupted by sweeping tariffs imposed by the US and the West Asia crisis triggered by the joint attack by the US and Israel on Iran, which has affected shipping routes and energy supplies.

Apart from WTO reforms, ministers are also likely to discuss fisheries subsidies, the China-led Investment Facilitation for Development (IFD) proposal, the e-commerce work programme and moratorium, development concerns and special and differential treatment (S&DT) provisions.

Agriculture
India will push for a perma-

nent solution on public stockholding (PSH) for food security programmes, an issue pending for more than a decade. It has also sought progress on the Special Safeguard Mechanism (SSM), which would allow developing and least developed countries to temporarily raise tariffs to deal with import surges or sudden price declines.

However, the Cairns Group of farm-exporting countries, including Australia and Brazil, argues that public stockholding distorts markets and opposes export restrictions. The United States has sought greater market access for its agricultural commodities, while the European Union has pushed for cuts in subsidies.

Dispute settlement
Reforms to the WTO's dispute settlement mechanism will also be discussed. The system has been partially dysfunctional since December 2019 as the appellate body has remained non-functional after the United States blocked the appointment of judges. Often described as the "crown jewel" of the WTO, the dispute settlement system allows members to resolve



conflicts either through consultations or through rulings by panels, which can be appealed before the appellate body. Since 2019, more than 20 appeals have been filed but remain pending.

Experts say the United States favours weakening the two-tier dispute settlement structure and may not support restoring the appellate body, while developing countries insist the two-tier system is essential for effective dispute resolution. Some developed members have suggested exploring alternatives to litigation.

E-commerce moratorium
India is also expected to reiterate concerns over the moratorium on customs duties on electronic transmissions. WTO members have agreed since 1998 not to impose such duties, and the arrangement has been extended periodically at

ministerial conferences.

India argues that persistent digital divides and limited access to technology restrict the participation of developing countries in global e-commerce. It has opposed extending the moratorium, saying it constrains policy space for domestic industrialisation and results in revenue losses.

Estimates suggest developing countries lose about \$10 billion annually in potential tariff revenue due to the moratorium, while India's losses could exceed \$500 million a year. Imports of digital products such as movies, music, video games and printed materials delivered electronically have been rising in the country. India has also raised concerns over Joint Statement Initiatives (JSIs), including the JSI on e-commerce, arguing that such plurilateral arrangements fragment the multilateral trading system.

Investment facilitation and development issues

A China-led group of around 128 countries is pushing for the Investment Facilitation for Development (IFD) agreement, which aims to sim-

plify investment procedures and would be binding only on signatory members. India had opposed the initiative at the previous ministerial conference in Abu Dhabi, citing lack of consensus.

Discussions are also expected on special and differential treatment (S&DT) provisions that give developing and least developed countries greater flexibility and longer timelines to implement WTO commitments. While some developed countries question the practice of self-designation as developing nations, countries such as India insist S&DT is vital for fair participation in global trade.

Fisheries subsidies

Negotiations on fisheries subsidies will also feature prominently. Developed members are pushing for stricter disciplines on subsidies that contribute to overfishing. India maintains that it is not a major subsidy provider compared with economies such as China, the EU and the US, and has argued that fuel subsidies offered by developed nations should also be subject to tighter rules.

AGENCIES

'Escalating Middle East crisis to impact Indian, other steel markets'

NEW DELHI: The global steel industry, including India, is likely to face multiple market-related issues in the coming days as the escalating crisis in the Middle East impacts fuels cost that has lead to increased freight rates, according to BigMint Research.

Military tensions in the region are increasing as both Iran, and the US, along with Israel, continue to attack each other. BigMint analysts said crude oil, LNG, and freight costs are rising simultaneously, transmitting cost pressure directly into steel and steel-related commodity markets.

From an average of \$70 a barrel before the war, crude oil prices have risen to about \$90/per barrel, an analyst said, adding that the cost is expected to continue to rise in the coming days. War has also impacted freight cost, which jumped almost 40 per cent in recent times. In the absence of insurance cover, marine operators are also offering freight at non-negotiable prices as per the availability of the vessel.

On the impact of the US-Iran conflict on steel markets, including India, they said the industry would face sustained input cost inflation across coal, scrap and ore, with freight and energy reinforcing one another.

"The players are expected to pass on the increased cost to customers. However, if market is not ready to absorb the cost, steel demand can also be affected," an expert said. Extended disruption could push prices of coking coal — a key steel making raw material — from major supplying markets such as Australia, Russia, and the US.

Increased input cost, coupled with higher freight cost, will also put pressure on the margins, he added.

PTI

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mr. Ganesh Nautiyal, Prop of M/s Excursion Earth (OPC) Pvt Ltd, R/o: GF 1B, Devika Tower, Nehru Place, Delhi-110019, Also At FF3, Lavana Mall, Mohkmpur, Dehradoon, Uttarakhand, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case CC NI ACT/3303/2023 U/s 138 P.S.: Mehrauli, New Delhi, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Mr. Ganesh Nautiyal, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Mr. Ganesh Nautiyal, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).**

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mr. Ganesh Nautiyal, accused of CC NI ACT/3303/2023 U/s 138 P.S.: Mehrauli, New Delhi, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 23.04.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Pooja Kumari
Judicial Magistrate, NI Act Sepecial Court, Saket Court No. 25, Saket Court Complex, New Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sahil @ Gajoomi, S/o: Abdul Salam, R/o: 15 Alvi Chowk Amir Khuro Nagar Basti Hazart Nizamuddin, New Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 310/2023 U/s 324 IPC P.S.: Hazrat Nizamuddin, New Delhi, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Sahil @ Gajoomi, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Sahil @ Gajoomi, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).**

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sahil @ Gajoomi, accused of FIR No. FIR No. 310/2023 U/s 324 IPC P.S.: Hazrat Nizamuddin, New Delhi, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 16.04.2026.**

By Order
Smt. Manuj Kaushal
JMFC-3, Room No. 512 Saket Court, New Delhi

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA Public Works Division Nanded

E-TENDER NOTICE NO. (23) FOR 2025-26

Online Tender (e-tender) in EPC form for the in Nanded District total 01 works are invited by the Executive Engineer, Public Works Division Nanded, Dist. Nanded (Phone No.02462-253711) on Government of Maharashtra Electronic Tender Management System, from the registered contractor in appropriate class of Public works Department of Maharashtra State. The details can be viewed and downloaded online directly from the Government of Maharashtra e-tender portal <https://mahatenders.gov.in/> on sub portal www.mahapwd.gov.in as under.

Note: 1) Details of the tender documents are available on e-tendering <https://mahatenders.gov.in/> and www.mahapwd.gov.in website of the Government of Maharashtra.

2) If there are any changes in the tender notice, then the information will be display on the website.

3) Executive Engineer, Public Works Division Nanded, Dist Nanded has reserved the right to accept or reject tenders.

DGIPR/2025/26/6388

Executive Engineer
Public Works Division Nanded

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.U/s 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely (1) **Marukh Khan S/o Harun Khan R/o B-2/17 G, Mayur Vihar Ph-III, Delhi, (2) Narender Singh @ Rohit S/o Prem Singh R/o Ropali Enclave Karala, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case FIR No. 66/2017 U/s 457/380/411/34 IPC PS: Vijay Vihar Distt. Rohini Delhi, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused (1) **Marukh Khan (2) Narender Singh @ Rohit** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused (1) **Marukh Khan (2) Narender Singh @ Rohit** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).**

Proclamation is hereby made that the said (1) **Marukh Khan (2) Narender Singh @ Rohit** accused of FIR No. 66/2017 U/s 457/380/411/34 IPC PS: Vijay Vihar Distt. Rohini Delhi, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 14.04.2026.

By Order
Ms. Shagun
JMFC-06, Room No.109 Rohini Court, Delhi

Canara Bank MAYAPURI BRANCH

DEMAND NOTICE [SECTION 13(2)]

Ref: CB 2017/SARFAESI/VANDANA/2025-26 Date: 06/03/2026

To
1. Mrs. VANDANA GANDHI (BORROWER)
ADD:- FLAT NO. 147-B, Pkt-DG2, VIKASPURI, NEW DELHI-110018
2. Mr. TILAK RAJ GANDHI (CO-BORROWER)
ADD:- FLAT NO. 147-B, Pkt-DG2, VIKASPURI, NEW DELHI-110018
3. Mr. VINEET GANDHI (GUARANTOR)
ADD:- FLAT NO. 147-B, Pkt-DG2, VIKASPURI, NEW DELHI-110018
Also at,
Mrs. VANDANA GANDHI W/o MR. TILAK RAJ GANDHI
FIRST FLOOR, GEETA LOK, SP VERMA ROAD, PATNA-800001

Dear Sir / Madam,
Sub: Notice issued under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation & Reconstruction of Financial Assets & Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.

The undersigned being the Authorized Officer of Canara Bank, MAYAPURI Branch (hereinafter referred to as "the secured creditor"), appointed under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, (hereinafter referred as the "Act") do hereby issue this notice to you as under:

That Mrs. Vandana Gandhi, Mr. Tilak Raj Gandhi and Mr. Vineet Gandhi (hereinafter referred to as "the Borrower, the Co-Borrower and Guarantor respectively") has availed credit facility / facilities stated in the Schedule A hereunder and has entered into the security agreement/s in favour of the secured creditor. While availing the said financial assistance, you have expressly undertaken to repay the loan amount/s in accordance with the terms and conditions of the above mentioned agreements.

That Mr. Vineet Gandhi (hereinafter referred to as "the Guarantor") has guaranteed the payment on demand of all moneys and discharge all obligations and liabilities owing or incurred to the secured creditor by the Borrower for credit facilities up to the limit of **Rs. 28,00,000/- (Rupees Twenty Eight Lakhs Only)** with interest thereon.

You (The person mentioned in schedule B) are also entered in to agreements against the secured assets which are detailed in Schedule B hereunder.

However, From July 2025 the operation and conduct of the said financial assistance / credit facilities have become irregular. The books of account maintained by the secured assets shows that the liability of the Borrower towards the secured creditor as on date amounts to **Rs 12,82,320.58 (Rupees: Twelve Lakhs Eighty Two Thousand Three Hundred Twenty and Paise Fifty Eight only)**, the details of which together with future interest rate are stated in Schedule C hereunder. It is further stated that the Borrower/Guarantor having failed to keep up with the terms of the above said agreement in clearing the dues of the secured creditor within the time given, and have been evasive in settling the dues.

The operation and conduct of the above said financial assistance / credit facility/ies having come to a standstill and as a consequence of the default committed in repayment of principal debt/ instalment and interest thereon, the secured creditor was constrained to classify the debt as Non Performing Asset (NPA) as on 28.02.2026 in accordance with the directives/guidelines relating to asset classification issued by the Reserve Bank of India. The secured creditor through this notice brings to your attention that the Borrower has failed and neglected to repay the said dues/ outstanding liabilities and hence hereby demand you under Section 13(2) of the Act, by issuing this notice to discharge in full the liabilities of the Borrower as stated in Schedule C hereunder to the secured creditor within 60 days from the date of receipt of this notice. Further, it is brought to your notice that you are also liable to pay future interest at the rate of as applicable, monthly compounded together with all costs, charges, expenses and incidental expenses with respect to the proceedings undertaken by the secured creditor in recovering its dues.

Please take note of the fact that if you fail to repay to the secured creditor the aforesaid sum of **Rs 12,82,320.58 (Rupees: Twelve Lakhs Eighty Two Thousand Three Hundred Twenty and Paise Fifty Eight only)**, together with further interest and incidental expenses and costs as stated above in terms of this notice under Section 13(2) of the Act, the secured creditor will exercise all or any of the rights detailed under sub-section (4)(a) and (b) of Section 13, the extract of which is given here below to convey the seriousness of this issue:

13(4)- In case the Borrower/Guarantor fails to discharge liability in full within the period specified in sub-section (2), the secured creditor may take recourse to one or more of the following measures to recover his secured debt, namely:
(a) Take possession of the secured assets of the Borrower/Guarantor including the right to transfer by way of lease, assignment or sale for realizing the secured asset;
(b) Take over the management of the business of the Borrower including the right to transfer by way of lease, assignment or sale for realizing the secured asset;

Provided that the right to transfer by way of lease, assignment or sale shall be exercised only where the substantial part of the business of the Borrower is held as security for the debt; Provided further that where the management of whole of the business or part of the business is severable, the secured creditor shall take over the management of such business of the borrower which is relatable to the security for the debt; and under other applicable provisions of the said Act.

Your attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets. You are also put on notice that in terms of section 13(13) the Borrower/Guarantor shall not transfer by way of sale, lease or otherwise the said secured assets detailed in Schedule B hereunder without obtaining written consent of the secured creditor. It is further brought to your notice that any contravention of this statutory injunction/ restraint, as provided under the said Act, is an offence and if for any reason, the secured assets are sold or leased out in the ordinary course of business, the sale proceeds or income realized shall be deposited with the secured creditor. In this regard you shall have to render proper accounts of such realization / income.

This notice of Demand is without prejudice to and shall not be construed as waiver of any other rights or remedies which the secured creditor may have including further demands for the sums found due and payable by you.

This is without prejudice to any other rights available to the secured creditor under the Act and/or any other law in force.

Please comply with the demand under this notice and avoid all unpleasantness. In case of Non-compliance, further needful action will be resorted to, holding you liable for all costs and consequence.

Thanking you,

Yours faithfully,

AUTHORIZED OFFICER CANARA BANK

SCHEDULE A
[Details of the credit facility/ies availed by the Borrower]

Sl No	Loan No	Nature of Loan/Limit	Date of sanction	Amount
1.	91979830000055	Mortgage Loan	09/02/2018	28,00,000.00
Total :				28,00,000.00

SCHEDULE B
[Details of security assets]

MOVABLE ASSETS		
S No	DESCRIPTION OF PROPERTY	NAME OF TITLE HOLDER
1	All the part & parcel of the property bearing FIAT No. 147-B, Pocket - DG-2, FIRST FLOOR, MIG, VIKASPURI, NEW DELHI-110018 Boundaries:- East:- Service Lane West:- Flat no. 148-B North:- Other's Property South:- Entry	Mrs. VANDANA GANDHI W/o Mr. TILAK RAJ GANDHI

SCHEDULE C
[Details of liability as on date]

Sl No	LOAN NO	NATURE OF LOAN/LIMIT	LIABILITY WITH INTEREST AS ON DATE 05.03.2026	RATE OF INTEREST
1.	91979830000055	Mortgage Loan	12,82,320.58	Mclr 8.75 plus penal interest
TOTAL			12,82,320.58	

Thanking you,

Yours faithfully,

AUTHORIZED OFFICER, CANARA BANK

India taps alternative supplies for crude as Iran conflict drags on

India imports about 88% of its crude oil requirement, with roughly half of those supplies in February passing through the Strait of Hormuz

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Indian refiners have begun negotiating for additional crude cargoes from the US, Russia and West Africa to ensure supplies remain adequate in the event of the Middle East conflict drags on for a longer period, industry officials and analysts said.

Refineries, which convert crude oil into fuels like petrol and diesel, have deferred planned maintenance shutdowns and are maintaining normal processing rates to create buffers that could meet the country's requirement in the near term, they said.

India imports about 88 per cent of its crude oil requirement, with roughly half of those supplies in February passing through the Strait of Hormuz, the narrow sea lane between Iran and Oman that serves as a key energy transit route for global markets.

The recent military strikes by the United States and Israel on Iran, and Tehran's retaliatory attacks on US bases in neighbouring countries as well as Israel, have sharply escalated tensions in the region, leading to a near halt in tanker movements through the strategic waterway. "Non-strait sources are fully



'Non-strait sources are fully operational and we are sourcing more and more supplies from non-conflict zones,' a top oil ministry source said

operational and we are sourcing more and more supplies from non-conflict zones," a top oil ministry source said. "Non-Strait sources accounted for 60 per cent of supplies in 2025 which after the Middle East conflict climbed to 70 per cent."

Indian refiners are tapping crude from West Africa, Latin America and the US, he said adding the US Treasury Department issuing a 30-day waiver to allow the sale and delivery of sanctioned Russian oil that has

Key Points

- » 'Non-Strait sources accounted for 60% of supplies in 2025 which after the Middle East conflict climbed to 70%'
- » 'Indian refiners are tapping crude from West Africa, Latin America and the US'
- » There were 120 million barrels of Russian crude on water. Of this, around 15 million barrels of Russia-origin crude are sitting on tankers close to India - in Arabian Sea and Bay of Bengal

already been loaded on vessels to India has opened up another avenue.

The waiver permits the sale, delivery or discharge of crude oil and petroleum products of Russian origin that were loaded onto vessels on or before March 5, including ships subject to certain sanctions. The exemption remains valid until April 5, allowing cargoes already in transit to be completed without violating sanctions restrictions. There were 120 million barrels

of Russian crude on the water. Of this, as many as 15 million barrels of Russia-origin crude are sitting on tankers close to India - in the Arabian Sea and Bay of Bengal - while another 7 million Russian crude barrels are idling near Singapore. Industry sources said Indian refiners have started buying Russian oil.

Reliance Industries, Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd and HPCL-Mittal Energy Ltd, which had halted purchases of Russian crude following US sanctions imposed last year on Moscow's leading producers Rosneft and Lukoil, have returned to the market to secure Russian cargoes, they said.

Before the US imposed sanctions on Russia's leading oil producers Rosneft and Lukoil in October 2025, Reliance Industries was the largest buyer of Russian crude, importing more than 500,000 barrels per day under a long-term supply agreement with Rosneft.

The Oil Ministry official said India never stopped buying Russian oil - it imported some 1.04 million barrels per day of Russian crude in February, down from 1.6-1.8 million bpd levels seen in 2023-2025.

"We are in a very comfortable position as far as crude

and finished products are concerned," he said, adding the combined inventory can meet the country's demand for 50 days. The country currently holds approximately 144 million barrels of crude in onshore storage, equivalent to around 30 days of coverage at 2025 import levels. Importantly, the supplies are being constantly replenished, he said.

India's Strategic Petroleum Reserves have the capacity to cover about 9.5 days of net oil imports. In addition, state-run oil companies have storage for crude and petroleum products equivalent to 64.5 days of net imports, taking the country's total storage capacity to roughly 74 days of net imports, according to petroleum ministry data.

While India may be able to secure adequate physical crude through alternative sources, analysts cautioned that the overall cost structure could worsen due to higher crude prices, increased freight and insurance premiums, and longer shipping routes. International crude oil prices have jumped to over \$92 per barrel from around \$70 when the US and Israel attacked Iran on February 28. LNG prices have more than doubled to \$24-25 per million British thermal unit.

West Asia conflict: FPIs withdraw ₹21K cr in last 4 trading sessions

Latest sell-off comes after FPIs infused Rs 22,615 cr into Indian equities in Feb, the highest inflow in 17 months

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Foreign investors pulled out Rs 21,000 crore (around \$2.3 billion) from Indian equities over the last four trading sessions amid deteriorating global risk sentiment triggered by the West Asia crisis.

The latest sell-off comes after foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) infused Rs 22,615 crore into Indian equities in February, the highest monthly inflow in 17 months.

Prior to that, FPIs had been net sellers for three consecutive months. They withdrew Rs 35,962 crore in January, Rs 22,611 crore in December, and Rs 3,765 crore in November, according to data from the depositories.

The latest outflows occurred during March 2-6, when FPIs sold equities worth about Rs 21,000 crore in the cash market. March 3 was a trading holiday on account of Holi.

Market experts attributed the pullout primarily to the rising geopolitical tensions in West Asia. The US and Israel launched a major attack on Iran on February 28 which killed Iran's Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, triggering conflict in the region.

Vaqqarjaved Khan, Senior Fundamental Analyst at Angel One, said fears of potential disruptions in the Strait of Hor-



Despite the FPI selling, the market has continued to find support from domestic institutional investors (DIIs) and steady inflows through mutual fund SIPs

muz pushed Brent crude prices above \$90 per barrel, triggering a global risk-off sentiment.

Other factors contributing to the outflows include rupee depreciation beyond the 92-per-dollar level, elevated US Treasury yields drawing capital back to safe-haven assets, and mixed early outlook for Q4 FY26 corporate earnings, particularly margin pressures in the IT and consumption sectors, he added.

VK Vijayakumar, Chief Investment Strategist at Geojit Investments, said "uncertainty surrounding the Middle

East conflict, the recent market correction, the Indian economy's vulnerability to a sharp rise in crude prices, and the depreciation of the rupee have all contributed to sustained FPI selling in the cash market."

Himanshu Srivastava, Principal Manager Research at Morningstar Investment Research India, noted that higher crude prices increase risks related to inflation, the current account deficit, and currency stability, which typically weigh on foreign investor sentiment toward emerging markets.

He added that global investors have also shifted towards safer assets such as the US dollar amid rising uncertainty. The recent uptick in US Treasury yields during the week further contributed to capital outflows from emerging markets.

Going ahead, Vijayakumar said FPIs are unlikely to return as buyers until there is greater clarity on the geopolitical situation and crude prices moderate.

"Brent crude trading above \$90 per barrel is negative for the Indian economy and equity markets," he said.

Despite the FPI selling, the market has continued to find support from domestic institutional investors (DIIs) and steady inflows through mutual fund systematic investment plans (SIPs).

ADNOC manages offshore output, onshore ops continue

ABU DHABI: Abu Dhabi National Oil Company (ADNOC) said on Saturday it is actively managing offshore output levels to address storage requirements amid the US-Israeli war on Iran, while its onshore operations are continuing.

"This approach preserves operational flexibility and will enable the company to resume normal operations without prolonged delay," ADNOC said in a statement.

The war, now in its eighth day, has blocked shipments through the Strait of Hormuz, the crucial waterway responsible for roughly 20% of global oil and LNG supply.

Analysts have predicted the UAE and Saudi Arabia would soon have to cut output as their oil storage fills up.

ADNOC said its operations are continuing, and that it is using export capacity that bypasses the strait as well as international storage facilities to ensure supply continuity to global markets, *Reuters* reported.

Saudi state oil giant Aramco is temporarily diverting some crude shipments to the Red Sea port of Yanbu to ensure supply continuity for customers unable to access the Gulf, Saudi state media said on Saturday. AGENCIES

Kuwait declares force majeure, cuts oil output amid Middle East conflict

DUBAI: Kuwait Petroleum Corporation began cutting oil output on Saturday and declared force majeure, adding to earlier oil and gas reductions from Iraq and Qatar as the US-Iran war blocked shipments from the Middle East for the eighth consecutive day.

The war has blocked the world's most important oil artery the Strait of Hormuz which is responsible for 20 per cent of global oil and LNG supply.

Analysts predict the United Arab Emirates and Saudi Arabia will have to also cut output soon as they run out of oil storage.

Kuwait Petroleum Corporation (KPC) declared force majeure, according to a trade notice seen by *Reuters*, after it implemented a reduction in crude oil production and refin-

KPC is a major exporter of naphtha to Asia and a major jet fuel exporter to north-west Europe

ing throughput because of the conflict in the Middle East.

The national oil company did not say by how much it would reduce output. In February, Kuwait produced around 2.6 million barrels per day of crude oil.

It said the reduction was precautionary and would be reviewed as the situation develops and it remained ready to restore production levels when conditions allow.

KPC declared force majeure because of what it said were explicit threats by Iran against

the safe passage of ships through the Strait of Hormuz, continuing attacks by Iran on Kuwait and the "almost total absence" within the Arabian Gulf of vessels available to ship crude oil and products, the notice showed.

The company declined to comment on the notice.

KPC is a major exporter of naphtha to Asia and a major jet fuel exporter to north-west Europe. Naphtha is a feedstock for petro-chemicals production.

The US-Israeli war on Iran has already spilled beyond Iran's borders, as Tehran has responded by hitting Israel and Gulf Arab states hosting US military installations and Israel has launched fresh attacks in Lebanon after the Iran-aligned militia Hezbollah fired across the border. AGENCIES

'Sufficient availability of fertilisers for now, but problems may arise if West Asia conflict prolongs'

KOCHI (Kerala): India currently has sufficient availability of fertilisers, but prolonged conflict in West Asia could pose problems, said a top official of Fertilisers and Chemicals Travancore Limited (FACT), the largest supplier to South Indian states.

FACT, a public sector company, relies on raw materials such as rock phosphate and phosphoric acid exported from several countries in West Asia and the Middle East, and they are brought via the sea route.

The prolonged conflict could cause significant damage to the global economy, according to analysts.

Currently, there is no harvest season in India; it will

begin after July, the Kochi-headquartered FACT's Managing Director S Sakthimani told PTI, when asked about the potential impact of the current global situation on fertiliser production in the country.

"We have sufficient urea available. We hope that things (the war situation) will probably be resolved within a month. We have sufficient urea available for our Kharif season. We will not have any problems," he said.

"But, if the situation continues for the next six months, problems may arise. It could cause problems in the next crop season, that is the Rabi season, and appropriate steps are being taken to address it," he added.

India has two main crop-

ping seasons - Kharif and Rabi. Kharif crops are sown with the onset of the monsoon in June-July and harvested around September-October, while Rabi crops are planted in October-November and harvested by April-May. Urea is widely used across the country to boost yields in both seasons.

Sakthimani said that companies like FACT not only source gas from the Middle East, but also from Australia.

"There are no problems with the gas line in that area right now. There is instability in some places, but that is not a problem for the fertiliser sector," he said.

The central government has procured stocks of di-ammonium phosphate (DAP) and

double super phosphate (DSP) from (various) companies, and this will not cause any problems, the official pointed out.

The FACT will ensure to fulfil every fertiliser requirement of the farmers, he said.

"We will supply. It is our duty and we will do it," the official added.

Agriculture and allied sectors are one of the largest sources of income in India and depend heavily on the fertiliser industry.

Referring to the global situation, Sakthimani said, "This is a temporary phase. There is no need to panic. With the support of the government, we will be in a position to supply whatever farmers need." PTI



Mcap of Reliance Industries Ltd jumped by Rs 14,750.39 cr to Rs 19,01,583.05 cr

Rs 10,55,567.27 crore. ICICI Bank's valuation eroded by Rs 46,936.82 crore to Rs 9,40,049.82 crore and that of HDFC Bank dived Rs 46,552.30 crore to Rs 13,19,107.08 crore.

Highlights

- » Mcap of Infosys climbed Rs 3,459.99 crore to Rs 5,30,546.54 crore
- » The market valuation of SBI tumbled Rs 53,952.96 crore to Rs 10,55,567.27 crore
- » ICICI Bank's mcap fell by Rs 46,936.82 cr to Rs 9,40,049.82 cr & that of HDFC Bank dived Rs 46,552.30 cr to Rs 13,19,107.08 cr

The valuation of Larsen & Toubro tanked Rs 45,629.03 crore to Rs 5,43,208.36 crore. The market capitalisation (mcap) of Bajaj Finance dropped by Rs 28,934.56

crore to Rs 5,91,136.03 crore and that of Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) diminished by Rs 28,492.44 crore to Rs 9,25,380.15 crore.

Hindustan Unilever's mcap declined by 26,350.67 crore to Rs 5,23,042.51 crore and that of Bharti Airtel edged lower by Rs 4,732.75 crore to Rs 10,67,120.50 crore.

However, the market valuation of Reliance Industries Ltd jumped Rs 14,750.39 crore to Rs 19,01,583.05 crore. The mcap of Infosys climbed Rs 3,459.99 crore to Rs 5,30,546.54 crore.

Reliance Industries remained the most valued domestic firm followed by HDFC Bank, Bharti Airtel, State Bank of India, ICICI Bank, TCS, Bajaj Finance, Larsen & Toubro, Infosys, and Hindustan Unilever. PTI

West Asia crisis & crude prices to drive markets this week: Analysts

NEW DELHI: Developments related to the ongoing conflict in West Asia and its impact on crude oil prices would be the major driving factors for stock markets this week, analysts said.

Besides, global market trends and trading activity of foreign investors would also drive investors' sentiment.

"This week, movements in global crude oil prices and further geopolitical developments in West Asia will remain critical external variables influencing market direction. The week will also feature key macroeconomic releases that could shape near-term sentiment.

"On the domestic front,



investors will closely monitor the Consumer Price Index (CPI) inflation data scheduled for March 12," Ajit Mishra - SVP, Research, Religare Broking Ltd, said.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 8.52 per cent to \$92.69 per barrel.

"The week ahead is likely to remain volatile, with mar-

ket sentiment largely shaped by persistent geopolitical tensions in the Middle East. Investors will closely track global developments, particularly movements in crude oil prices, as energy markets continue to play a critical role in influencing overall risk appetite," Ponnudi R, CEO - Enrich Money, an online trading and wealth tech firm, said.

In addition, foreign institutional investor (FII) flows and currency movements will remain key variables to watch, as they provide important signals on global capital allocation trends and investor confidence in emerging markets such as India, he added. PTI

Gold poised for volatile week amid Middle East tensions, say analysts

NEW DELHI: Gold prices are expected to remain volatile next week as investors track geopolitical developments in the Middle East and key macroeconomic data releases that could shape the sentiment in the domestic market, analysts said.

"Focus will again be on the developments in the Middle-East and further escalation would be positive for gold prices, but a sign of de-escalation may trigger sharp selling," Pranav Mer, Vice President, EBG - Commodity & Currency Research, JM Financial Services Ltd, said.

Mer added that silver is



also undergoing a consolidation phase but remains highly volatile.

Globally, silver futures on the Comex slumped \$8.98, or nearly 10 per cent, while gold prices fell \$89.2, or 1.7 per cent, during the past week.

Analysts noted that major global ETFs are witnessing outflows as traders, especially from

the Middle East region, look to book profits or raise liquidity amid the escalating conflict. At the same time, surging energy prices have reduced expectations of a near-term interest rate cut by the US Federal Reserve at its June meeting.

Investors will watch key releases, including China's inflation and trade data, and inflation readings from the US, Germany, and India. Later in the week, provisional GDP, Personal Consumption Expenditures (PCE) price index and US consumer sentiment will guide the global growth and monetary policy outlook, they added. PTI

NEW DELHI: India's top three food delivery players — Swiggy, magicpin and Zomato — regained growth momentum in the December quarter (Q3) after a period of slower expansion, on strong order volumes led by festive demand, affordability-focused offerings and expanding user bases.

With continued investments in marketing, product innovation, and value-led propositions, industry executives said the sector expects the momentum in order growth to sustain in the coming quarters.

"It has been a phenomenal December quarter for

CLOSER LOOK

- » Swiggy's gross order value grew 20.5% year-on-year to Rs 8,959 cr, marking fastest growth in last three years
- » Zomato posted 16.6% year-on-year net order value (NOV) growth at Rs 9,846 crore in December quarter
- » magicpin reported more than 40% growth in GOV in cities, including Bengaluru, Hyderabad, and Mumbai

us, marked by strong growth and sharper execution across markets. Our unit economics at an order level have improved by over 60 per cent, reflecting greater efficiency and improved monetisation," magicpin Founder and CEO

Anshoo Sharma said. While mature markets such as Delhi-NCR remained steady, the company reported more than 40 per cent growth in gross order value (GOV) in cities, including Bengaluru, Hyderabad, and Mumbai.

The magicpin CEO said affordability-led consumption is a key growth driver, with an average order value of Rs 150-Rs 300 encouraging frequent ordering among users.

According to Swiggy's Q3 FY26 shareholder letter, the company's GOV grew 20.5 per cent year-on-year to Rs 8,959 crore, marking the fastest growth in the last three years.

Swiggy said the acceleration was driven by stronger adoption of new propositions across speed, selection and affordability. Its average monthly transacting user (MTU) base grew 22 per cent year-on-year to 24.3

million in Q3 from 17.8 million a year ago, while total orders rose to 294 million from 234 million during the period.

Zomato's food delivery business also reported improving growth trends during the quarter under review. The company posted 16.6 per cent year-on-year net order value (NOV) growth at Rs 9,846 crore in the December quarter translating into 21.3 per cent growth in GOV. This marked an acceleration from 13.8 per cent growth in the Q2. Its average monthly transacting users grew 21 per cent year-on-year to 24.9 million in Q3. AGENCIES

T20 WORLD CUP

Suryakumar finds unique winning formula to tame the grandest stage

AHMEDABAD: Suryakumar Yadav had a rather mischievous look on his face right after Tilak Varma held on to a skier by Jacob Duffy, hardly reflective of the elation that the Indian team might have felt after defending its T20 World Cup title with a 96-run win over New Zealand here on Sunday.

But then it was typical Suryakumar -- rarely over the top in his expressions whether in victory or defeat. The title win was a just reward for the man who led the team without any frills, a captain who copped a fair amount of criticism for not coming good with the bat.

Going into the World Cup, nobody would not have wanted to be in Suryakumar's shoes.

Until the home bilateral series against New Zealand, the Mumbaier was struggling to cobble together a decent score, and, in fact, his last 50-plus score came way back in 2024.

To be precise, just 100 runs in 11 innings in that period.

Even when the usual heights deserted SKY, he would not lose heart, saying he is not out of form but just short of runs. It's tough for one from outside to find the difference between those two cricketing states, but Suryakumar then has always been his own man, governed by his own rules.

Eventually, he broke out of the vault, scoring three fifties across five T20s against the



Suryakumar Yadav waves the Indian tricolour as he celebrates after winning the ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026 final match between India and New Zealand, at Narendra Modi Stadium, in Ahmedabad on Sunday

Kiwis. While as a batter that could have been a solace for him, but leading the team into a home World Cup where fans expect nothing less than a trophy is an altogether different proposition.

Before him, only one Indian captain had won a World Cup at home, when the incomparable MS Dhoni led the team to triumph in the 2011 50-over World Cup. Even some of the legendary names like Kapil

Dev (1986) and Rohit Sharma (2023) had failed to lift the title on home soil.

History might have been weighing heavily against Suryakumar but he has hardly ever been a man suppressed by the past. There was an additional of pressure of taking over a triumphant team from Rohit Sharma, whose last act in India's T20I jersey was lifting the title in Barbados in 2024.

So, nothing less than

another trophy was expected of Suryakumar. And at 35, this was practically his last shot at glory as it's tough to envisage him in India colours two years down the road.

Whether he likes it or not, there would have always been comparison with Rohit.

But he found a way to tackle this multi-headed monster -- take no pressure at all.

It was evident in his press conferences during this

Highlights

- » Going into the World Cup, nobody would not have wanted to be in Suryakumar's shoes
- » It was evident in his press conferences during this tournament
- » History might have been weighing heavily against Suryakumar but he has hardly ever been a man suppressed by the past

tournament.

Suryakumar was asked about bringing back Abhishek Sharma into the eleven after a stomach bug laid him low ahead of the Super Eight match against Pakistan in Colombo.

It was a serious cricketing question but Suryakumar chose to reply in jest: "If you (reporters) want him, we will play him." He adopted a similar approach to questions pertaining to Kuldeep Yadav, and Sanju Samson, playing down the queries with a smile and funny answers. On the surface, his replies appeared annoying to some but it was clear that Suryakumar did not want to give too many of his thoughts away, which could lead to chatter even before a game started.

AGENCIES

INDIAN FOOTBALL LEAGUE

Rodriguez strike secures Diamond Harbour's win

KALYANI: Diamond Harbour FC secured their first-ever Indian Football League (IFL) 2025-26 victory after edging past Dempo SC 2-1 at the Kalyani Stadium here on Sunday.

Antonio Moyano gave the home side the lead in added time of the first half. A second half strike by Marcus Joseph equalised the score and Hugo Diaz's strike in the 70th minute gave Diamond Harbour their first win.

In the day's second match, Shillong Lajong FC came from a goal behind to secure three points against Real Kashmir FC for their first win in the season at the SSA Stadium in Shillong.

Sejoseph Haokip gave the lead for the Snow Leopards while strikes from Phrangki Buam and Kenstar Kharshong gave Shillong Lajong full points.

Earlier, Dempo created a couple of half-chances in the opening 10 minutes, but Diamond Harbour soon regained control. The hosts dictated the tempo and heavily dominated possession throughout the first half, doing everything

right except finding the back of the net.

The breakthrough finally arrived deep into first-half stoppage time (45+4') against the run of play.

Catching Dempo off guard on a rapid counter-attack, Spanish midfielder Antonio Moyano produced a brilliant finish, executing a fantastic scoop over the goalkeeper to give Diamond Harbour a well-deserved 1-0 lead going into the break.

The second half proved to be a topsy-turvy affair as both teams hunted for goals.

The Trinidadian forward Marcus Leric Jr Joseph showcased his individual brilliance, expertly going past two defenders before slotting home a calm finish to make it 1-1.

Searching for a winner, Coach Vicuna made an inspired substitution that paid dividends just two minutes after the change. In the 70th minute, substitute Bryce Brian Miranda delivered a precise cross into the box, and Hugo Diaz Rodriguez was perfectly positioned to restore Diamond Harbour's lead with a clinical finish.

AGENCIES

Australia outclass India in one-off women's D/N Test

PERTH: Australia translated their overwhelming dominance over the last three days into a lop-sided 10-wicket win over India in the one-off women's day-night Test here on Sunday.

Australia earlier did the ground work for their victory, bowling out India for 149 in their second innings, and then scaled down a nominal target of 25 without any ado.

It was also a fitting farewell for skipper Alyssa Healy, who ended her career in Baggy Green with a magnificent win over a rival against whom she always excelled.

Writing was very much on the wall once India started the third day at 105 for six. Overnight India batters Pratika Rawal (63) and Sneha Rana (30) took India to 132.

Rawal showed excellent temperament during her fifty but the task was way too tall for her to manage.

Once Rana was ousted by Ash Gardener with a quick delivery taking out the batter's off-stump, India combusted quickly.

A combination of Gardener and Player of the Match



25
Australia openers Georgia Voll and Phoebe Litchfield were never going to be challenged by a target of 25, and the pair did the job with ease in just 4.3 overs

Annabel Sutherland fittingly ended India's innings. Sutherland

land took a fine tumbling catch at the edge of the circle when Rawal's mistimed pull off the off-spinner failed to find power or distance.

It also signalled the end of India's second innings.

Australia openers Georgia Voll and Phoebe Litchfield were never going to be challenged by a target of 25, and the pair did the job with ease in just 4.3 overs.

"We started well in T20Is with a series win, but could not continue the good work in ODIs and Tests but playing a full series in Australia was a good experience.

The Pink Ball Test was a different challenge," said India skipper Harmanpreet Kaur said after the match.

AGENCIES

Wrexham leads twice and takes Chelsea to extra time before losing 4-2 in FA Cup

The crowd erupted in the 18th minute when Sam Smith chased a long ball from Callum Doyle and fired low past Robert Sanchez to put Wrexham in front

WREXHAM: Against the world champion, Wrexham came agonisingly close to another spectacular plot twist.

Substitute Lewis Brunt was a matter of inches offside when he headed in what looked like an equalizing goal in a thrilling FA Cup fifth round clash against Premier League giant Chelsea on Saturday.

Wrexham - in front of Hollywood owners Ryan Reynolds and Rob Mac - led twice at the Racecourse Ground and, even down to 10 men in extra time, pushed Chelsea right down to the wire before eventually losing 4-2.

"Proud of the team today and every day," Mac posted on Instagram.

Goals from Alejandro Garnacho and Joao Pedro in extra time ultimately proved the difference between Club World Cup champion Chelsea and a Wrexham team that was playing non-league soccer just three years ago.

But even in defeat, Wrex-



There were more chances to extend the lead, but Chelsea leveled in fortuitous circumstances before the break

ham issued a statement of its potential as it aims to secure a fourth straight promotion this season and face the likes of Chelsea on a regular basis in the Premier League.

"It was one of the hardest games of the season so far," Garnacho told the BBC.

That was some admission, considering Chelsea has played Bayern Munich, Barcelona and Napoli in the Champions League this season. But it was a measure of just how close

Wrexham came to a famous Cup upset in front of its fans.

Reynolds and Mac - formerly known as McElhenney - were up on their feet and applauding Phil Parkinson's players when the drama was finally brought to an end.

The actors have witnessed some spectacular moments since their \$2.5 million takeover in 2021 transformed the fortunes of the once down-on-its-luck Welsh club. And, even in defeat, this was another

match that will live long in the memory of Wrexham supporters.

"It's been a great cup run. Tonight was a great spectacle and we were competitive against a very good side. We will take a lot of positives from it," said Parkinson, the Wrexham manager.

The home crowd erupted in the 18th minute when Sam Smith chased a long ball from Callum Doyle and fired low past Robert Sanchez to put Wrexham in front.

There were more chances to extend the lead, but Chelsea leveled in fortuitous circumstances before the break.

George Thomason denied Garnacho an equalizer when clearing his goalbound effort off the line. But his clearance hit the back of goalkeeper Arthur Okonkwo and rebounded into the net. Wrexham led for the second time in the 78th when Doyle produced a clever back-heeled flick from Josh Windass' shot from distance.

AGENCIES

India thrash Uruguay 4-0 in FIH Women's World Cup Qualifiers

HYDERABAD: The Indian women's hockey team opened its FIH World Cup Qualifiers 2026 campaign with a dominant 4-0 win over Uruguay here on Sunday.

Sunelita Toppo (21'), Ishika (40'), Lalremsiami (49') and Rutuja Dadaso Pisal (58') scored for the home side.

It was a bright start to the match in the first quarter as India made multiple circle entries and several goal-scoring chances.

In the 4th minute, the home side won the first penalty corner of the night as Udit found the net after a beautifully orchestrated variation but her shot went a bit high and hence the goal wasn't given.

Uruguay too had their moments as they banked on counterattacking hockey but India's resilient backline held their ground.

In the 21st minute, India broke the deadlock through a penalty corner as Sunelita Toppo (21') showed great reflexes to pounce on the rebound and tap the ball into the net to open the scoring.

Five minutes later, India received another penalty corner but this time, Annu's drag flick was



Key Points

- » It was a bright start to the match in the first quarter as India made multiple circle entries and several goal-scoring chances
- » Uruguay too had their moments as they banked on counterattacking hockey but India's resilient backline held their ground

INDIA WILL NEXT FACE SCOTLAND ON MONDAY.

stopped by the Uruguayan defence. India held most of the possession in the second quarter.

In the 29th minute Uruguay won their first penalty corner of the night but the opportunity was squandered as India man-

aged to swiftly defend their goal and hold the slim lead. In the 36th minute, India were through on goal as Navneet Kaur found herself unmarked in front of the post but Uruguay's goalkeeper Maria Bate stepped out and delivered a decisive save.

AGENCIES

OFFICE OF THE RECOVERY OFFICER
DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL-I, DELHI
4th FLOOR, JEEVAN TARA BUILDING, PARLIAMENT STREET, NEW DELHI-110001

SALE PROCLAMATION

R.C. No. 121/2024 **Date of Auction Sale: 10/04/2026**

PROCLAMATION OF SALE UNDER RULE 38, 52(2) OF SECOND SCHEDULE TO THE INCOME TAX ACT, 1961 READ WITH THE RECOVERY OF DEBTS DUE TO BANK AND FINANCIAL INSTITUTIONS ACT, 1993.

CENTRAL BANK OF INDIA Vs. NEHA MANOCHA

(CD 1) NEHA MANOCHA W/O SANJEEV KUMAR MANOCHA,
R/o 1/106, Ground Floor, Old Rajinder Nagar, New Delhi-110060
Also At: WZ 1079, 11nd Floor, Rani Bagh, Delhi-110034.
(CD 2) SANJEEV KUMAR MANOCHA S/O RAJENDER KUMAR MANOCHA
R/o 1/106, Ground Floor, Old Rajinder Nagar, New Delhi-110060
Also At: WZ 1079, 11nd Floor, Rani Bagh, Delhi-110034.

- Whereas Recovery Certificate No.121/2024 in TA No.16 of 2023 drawn by the Presiding Officer, Debts Recovery Tribunal-I for the recovery of a sum of **Rs.85,07,507.11 together with costs and future interest @ 10.70% p.a., from the date of filing of TA i.e. 18/09/2021**, till its realization and also to pay cost as per certificate from the Certificate Debtors together with costs and charges as per recovery certificate.
- And whereas the undersigned has ordered the sale of property mentioned in the Schedule below in satisfaction of the said Certificate.
- And whereas there will be due there under a sum of **Rs.85,07,507.11 together with costs and future interest @ 10.70% p.a., from the date of filing of TA i.e. 18/09/2021**, till its realization and also to pay cost as per recovery certificate. Notice is hereby given that in absence of any order of postponement, the property / properties as under shall be sold by e-auction and bidding shall take place through "On line Electronic Bidding" through the website <https://bankauctions.in> on **10/04/2026 between 12:00 PM and 01:00 PM** with extensions of 5 minutes duration after 01:00 PM, if required.
- The description of the property proposed to be e-auctioned is as follows :

S.No.	Description of Property	Reserve Price (In Rs.)	EMD
1.	Property i.e. Ground Floor Without Roof Rights Baring No.1/ 106, Old Rajinder Nagar, New Delhi (Measuring 57.4 Sq.Yds.)	Rs.67.00 Lakhs	Rs.6.70 Lakhs

- The EMD shall be paid through Demand Draft / Pay Order in favour of **Recovery Officer, DRT-I, Delhi- A/c. R.C. No.121/2024** along with self - attested copy of Identity (voter I-card/Driving License/Passport) which should contain the address for future communication and self-attested copy of PAN Card must reach to the Office of the Recovery Officer, DRT-I, Delhi **latest by 07/04/2026 before 5:00 PM**. The EMD received thereafter shall not be considered. The said deposit be adjusted in the case of successful bidders. The unsuccessful bidder shall take return of the EMD directly from the Registry, DRT-I, Delhi after receipt of such report from e-auction service provider / bank / financial institution on closure of the e-auction sale proceedings.
- The envelope containing EMD should be super-scribed "**R.C. No.121/2024**" alongwith the details of the sender i.e. address, e-mail ID and Mobile Number etc.
- Intending bidders shall hold a valid Login ID and Password to participate in the E-Auction email address and PAN Number. For details with regard to Login ID & Password, please contact **M/s 4 Closure, 605A, 6th Floor, Maltrivnam, Ameerpet, Hyderabad-500038, Contact Person: Shailendra Srivastava - 8142000030, 8142000060, 040-23736405, E-mail: info@bankauctions.in; shailendra@bankauctions.in**
- Prospective bidders are required to register themselves with the portal and obtain user ID/Password well in advance, which is mandatory for bidding in above e-auction from **M/s 4 Closure**.
- Details of concerned Bank Officers / Helpline Numbers etc. are as under :-

Name & Designation	Email & Phone Nos.
NAVEEN KUMAR (Senior Manager)	Mob: 9999210655

- What is proposed to be sold are the rights to which the certificate debtors are entitled in respect of the properties. The properties will be sold along with liabilities, if any. The extent of the properties shown in the proclamation is as per the Recovery Certificate schedule. Recovery Officer shall not be responsible for any variation in the extent due to any reason. The properties will be sold on "**As is where is**" and "**as is what is**" condition.
- The property can be inspected by prospective bidder(s) before the date of sale for which the above named officer of the bank may be contacted.
- The undersigned reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids if found unreasonable or postpone the auction at any time without assigning any reason.
- EMD of unsuccessful bidders will be received by such bidders from the Registry of **DRT-I**, on identification / production of Identity proof viz., PAN Card, Passport, Voters ID, Valid Driving License or Photo Identity Card issued by Govt. and PSUs. Unsuccessful bidders shall ensure return of their EMD and, if not received within a reasonable time, immediately contact the Recovery Officer, DRT-I, Delhi / or the Bank.
- The sale will be of the property of the above named CDs as mentioned in the schedule below and the liabilities and claims attaching to the said property, so far as they have been ascertained are those specified in the schedule against each lot.
- The property will be put up for the sale in the lots specified in the schedule. If the amount to be realized is satisfied by the sale of a portion of the property, the sale shall be immediately stopped with respect to the remainder. The sale also be stopped if, before any lot is knocked down, the arrears mentioned in the said certificate, interest costs (including cost of the sale) are tendered to the officer conducting the sale or proof is given to his satisfaction that the amount of such certificate, interest and costs have been paid to the undersigned.
- No officer or other person, having any duty to perform in connection with sale, however, either directly or indirectly bid for, acquire or attempt to acquire any interest in the property sold.
- The sale shall be subject to the conditions prescribed in the Second Schedule to the Income Tax Act, 1961 and the rules made there under and to the further following conditions : The particulars specified in the annexed schedule have been stated to the best of the information of the undersigned, but the undersigned shall not be answerable for any error, mis-statement or omission in this proclamation.
- The amount by which the biddings are to be increased shall be in multiple of **Rs.20,000/- (Rupees Twenty Thousand Only)**. In the event of any dispute arising as to the amount of bid, or as to the bidder, the lot shall at once be again put up to auction.
- The Successful / Highest bidder shall be declared to be the purchaser of any lot provided that further that the amount bid by him is not less than the reserve price. It shall be in the discretion of the undersigned to decline acceptance of the highest bid when the price offered appears so clearly inadequate as to make it inadvisable to do so.
- Successful / Highest bidder shall have to prepare DD / Pay Order for 25% of the sale proceeds favouring **Recovery Officer, DRT-I, Delhi, A/c. R.C. No.121 / 2024** within 24 hours after close of e-auction and after adjusting the earnest money (EMD) and sending / depositing the same in the office of the Recovery Officer so as to reach within 3 days from the close of e-auction failing which the earnest money (EMD) shall be forfeited.
- The successful / Highest Bidder shall deposit, through Demand Draft / Pay Order favouring **Recovery Officer, DRT-I, Delhi A/c. R.C. 121 / 2024**, the balance 75% of the sale proceeds before the Recovery Officer, DRT-I on or before 15th Day from the date of sale of the property, exclusive of such day, or if the 15th day be Sunday or other holiday, then on the first office day after the 15th day alongwith the poundage fee @ 2% upto Rs.1,000 and @ 1% on the excess of such gross amount over Rs. 1000/- in favour of Registrar, DRT-I, Delhi. (In case of deposit of balance amount of 75% through post the same should reach the Recovery Officer as above).
- In case of default of payment within the prescribed period, the property shall be resold, after the issue of fresh proclamation of sale. The deposit, after defraying the expenses of the sale, may, if the undersigned thinks fit, be forfeited to the Government and the defaulting purchaser shall forfeit all claims to the property or to any part of the sum for which it may subsequently be sold.

SCHEDULE OF PROPERTY

Lot No.	Description of the property to be sold with the names of the co-owners where the property belongs to the defaulter and any other person as co-owners	Revenue assessed upon the property or any part thereof	Details of any encumbrance to which property is liable	Claims, if any, which have been put forward to the property, and any other known particulars bearing on its nature and value
1.	Property i.e. Ground Floor Without Roof Rights Baring No.1/ 106, Old Rajinder Nagar, New Delhi. (Measuring 57.4 Sq.Yds.)			No information received.

Given under my hand and seal on 12/02/2026

Sd/- NIRANJAN SHARMA, RECOVERY OFFICER-II, DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL-I, DELHI



WOMEN'S DAY SPECIAL

WOMEN DIRECTORS TAKE THE LEAD

Across languages and regions, women filmmakers of India are creating powerful stories that are winning awards and hearts worldwide



ANINDITA ACHARYA



Only two days ago, the trailer of 'Dhurandhar 2: The Revenge' starring Ranveer Singh dropped, promising yet another spectacle of bloodshed and brute masculinity. Films like 'Dhurandhar', 'Animal', 'Toxic' or 'Tere Ishk Mein' continue to dominate the conversation with their loud, violent, male-driven narratives that thrive on raw adrenaline. But even as this brand of cinema grabs the spotlight, a quieter yet powerful shift is slowly reshaping the storytelling landscape of Indian cinema. Across languages and regions, women filmmakers are telling stories that are intimate, rooted, human and the world is listening.

From Lakshmi Priya Devi's Manipuri film 'Boong' to Rima Das's 'Not a Hero'; from Payal Kapadia's 'All We Imagine As Light' to Shuchi Talati's 'Girls Will Be Girls' or Kiran Rao's 'Laapataa Ladies', these films are doing far more than entertaining audiences. They are asking questions, opening conversations and in many cases, sweeping international festivals with awards and critical acclaim. Add to that 'Santoshi' by Sandhya Suri and 'Bunnyhood' by Mansi Maheshwari, which offer fresh perspectives.

Lakshmi Priya created history with her 2024 Manipuri film 'Boong', which became the first Indian film to win a BAFTA in the 'Best Children's & Family Film' category. The film traces the journey of a young boy searching for



his father amid the turbulence of conflict. After travelling across global festivals, the film was finally released across India this week.

Meanwhile, Rima Das continues to chart her own path with remarkable consistency. The Assamese filmmaker, who earlier stunned audiences with 'Village Rockstars', has once again drawn global attention with 'Not a Hero'. The film recently received a 'Crystal Bear Special Mention' at the Berlin International Film Festival 2026. Her earlier film 'Village Rockstars' not only earned the National Award for 'Best Feature Film' and 'Best Editing', but was also selected as India's official entry to the 91st Academy Awards. 'Village Rockstars 2', which had its European premiere at the 75th edition of the Berlinale International Film Festival last year, has now been released in theatres.

"This recognition is deeply meaningful to me. 'Not a Hero' was made by listening closely and trusting children, their quiet strength, their courage and their right to choose who they want to become," said Das after winning the 'Crystal Bear Special Mention' at Berlinale 2026 for 'Not a Hero'.

Lakshmi Priya, too, has spoken candidly about the journey of making 'Boong'. In an interview with 'The Hollywood Reporter', she admitted they always knew they were not making a Rs 100-crore spectacle where every moment is meticulously engineered. Instead, the filmmaking process unfolded as what she described as a 'series of happy accidents', with the team simply waiting for the right platform to discover their work.

In the more mainstream corner of the industry, Alankrita Shrivastava has emerged as one of the most consistent

voices. From the fearless 'Lipstick Under My Burkha' to series like 'Made in Heaven' and 'Bombay Begums' and films like 'Dolly Kitty Aur Woh Chamakte Sitare', Shrivastava has managed to navigate Bollywood while staying true to the stories she believes in.

In an interview, she had spoken about the invisible barriers women filmmakers still face in the industry.

"The entitlement that a male filmmaker will have, no matter how badly his film(s) have done, is shocking. The budgets they can demand and get... Women, on the other hand, even when successful, tend to be on the back foot," she had said.

For decades, Indian cinema has largely been shaped by the male gaze. But that narrative is slowly, steadily being rewritten. Women filmmakers are challenging conventions, centring voices that were once pushed to the margins and bringing complex social realities to the forefront. In fact, a glance at major international film festivals today reveals a striking trend: many of the most celebrated Indian films are being directed by women.

“Not a Hero’ was made by listening closely and trusting children, their quiet strength, their courage and their right to choose who they want to become”

— RIMA DAS



they should be paid the same amount. But I also feel the economics work in a certain



‘Economics work in a certain way’

Pay parity has long been a subject of debate in the Indian film industry, with many actors and filmmakers weighing in on the disparity between the earnings of male and female stars. Speaking about the issue on Soha Ali Khan's podcast, Saif Ali Khan and Kunal Kemmu explained that remuneration is largely driven by box office economics and audience demand rather than gender.

During the conversation, Saif stated that actors of similar stature should ideally receive equal pay; however, the industry's payment structure is deeply tied to the ability to draw audiences to theatres. "If the actors are of equal stature, they should be paid the same amount. But I also feel the economics work in a certain

Saif is all for pay parity, but believes that those 'putting people in seats' should be paid more

way. If you are putting people in seats in the theatre, you get paid accordingly. Everyone understands that relationship," said Saif. He added that the system isn't meant to favour one gender over another but rather reflects an actor's market value.

"It's not like just because you are a certain gender you deserve to be paid more or less. It's actually a very balanced economic system where people are clear that this person is a superstar because they are filling theatres. They know their worth, charge that price and get paid," added Saif.

Kunal Kemmu, meanwhile, broke down the 'maths' behind how actor salaries are decided in the industry. AGENCIES

‘MONSTERS, INC 3’ IN DEVELOPMENT AT ‘PIXAR’



LOS ANGELES: The third instalment to the acclaimed animated franchise 'Monsters, Inc' is in the works at 'Pixar'.

According to the entertainment news outlet 'Variety', the news was announced in the 'Wall Street Journal'.

Directed by Pete Docter, the first film was released in 2001 and revolved around two monsters, Sulley and Mike, working for an energy company that requires them to scare children. However, things change after meeting a human girl.

The second film, 'Monsters University', was released in 2013 and was directed by Dan Scanlon. It followed Mike and Sulley joining Monsters University in order to gradu-

ate as the scariest monsters on the planet. Both films emerged as massive successes for 'Pixar', with the first film grossing over USD 528 million at the box office and the second instalment crossing USD 700 million.

More details about the upcoming film are kept under wraps. Besides 'Monsters, Inc', Pixar is also working on 'Toy Story 5', 'The Incredibles 3', 'Coco 2' and others. P11

SRK calls Anil Kapoor ‘restrained yet effective’ in ‘Subedaar’

Suresh Triveni's action thriller 'Subedaar' is getting rave reviews from across the film industry, particularly for the towering central performance of Anil Kapoor. The admirers now include superstar Shah Rukh Khan and filmmaker Anurag Kashyap. While the former heaped praises on the film and its ensemble star cast, Kashyap wished the film had been a theatrical release instead of dropping directly on Amazon Prime Video.

Shah Rukh Khan took to his 'X' handle and wrote, "Thoroughly enjoyed #Subedaar. Can always count on @AnilKapoor to give it his all - a restrained yet effective performance. His dedication to the craft is inspiring and the action was so good." He then mentioned the supporting cast - Aditya Rawal, Saurabh Shukla, Mona Singh, Faisal Malik and Radhika Madan - adding, "Each character was crafted uniquely and all of u put on such a great performance."

Shah Rukh also lauded Triveni and the entire team of 'Subedaar'. Anil replied to Shah Rukh on 'X', writing, "Shah Rukh, so happy you saw 'Subedaar'. Your words mean a lot to all of us, especially coming from someone who has given audiences so much love and magic through cinema over the years. Makes this more special for all of us (hug emoji)."

Anurag Kashyap took to his 'Instagram' handle and posted a still of Anil Kapoor from 'Subedaar'. AGENCIES



#ViralFeed

Ananya Panday

stuns in a gorgeous saree at a prestigious award ceremony



PRE-NATAL PHYSIOTHERAPY: WOMEN WITHOUT PAIN

Pregnancy isn't a disease; it's a journey. Make it beautiful with physiotherapy

AUTHOR



DR ANSHUL GARHPALE

A woman resembles the pillar of strength in our society, but what if she is troubled by her own body, like her hormones? Pregnancy is a very crucial phase of any woman's life, where she has a mixed feeling of excitement, nervousness, curiosity or anxiety. Science here, in the form of antenatal physiotherapy, plays a vital role in maintaining her overall balance and strength.

A woman, who was once a girl and who used to ignore her monthly cycles just because of carelessness, may have to pay for this in her adulthood. There-

fore, all girls should be aware of their physical and psychological health. Now, here's a very important point about how physiological health can affect the psychological health of any individual, especially girls. Let's check this: a girl with an irregular menstrual cycle with heavy bleeding is suffering from lower abdomen pain and weakness. She takes leave from her school/college for those few days. Meanwhile, she experiences anxiety due to her absence from work. She recovers from her physical condition and goes to her routine work, but gets scolded due to irregularity; the anxiety has now been automatically converted into a minimal level of stress, which ultimately leads to an increase in academic pressure. This is what we call unfit psychological health, which is basically due to impaired physiological health.

This girl will someday move towards adulthood, who again will share the motherhood journey, facing the troubles, which can worsen day by day. This needs to be taken care of, as it's never too late to get awakened. Hormones are the roots of all

our physiological and psychological conditions. The major hormones in a female's body, FSH & LH, are the major governing centres for any female's health. If we can't change them, we can definitely monitor them and modify their functions by changing our daily routines and increasing our metabolism.

Every female body is made in such a way that she can modify her hormones to a greater extent by changing daily activities, which may not only affect the metabolism but will also definitely change her health conditions. Similarly, a pregnant mother can also make remarkable changes to her body, leading to a healthy and fit pregnancy.

What is Pre-Natal Physiotherapy: The prenatal period is the duration of pregnancy, from conception till the birth of the baby. The physiotherapy sessions scheduled during this period to provide ease and comfort in the complete gestation period, with faster recovery of the mother, are known as prenatal physiotherapy. This comprises multiple planned sessions for mothers and sometimes for couples, too. The



sessions for the couples are planned to teach would-be fathers to take care of the pregnant female, to cope with some complications occurring during the pregnancy and to teach good parenting for the newborn babies. The pregnant woman learns how to perform daily activities with a growing belly. The various sleepless nights, discomforts, anxiety, nausea, vomiting, heaviness and multiple pains in different parts of the body can all be

settled down with the help of prenatal physiotherapy.

Not only during pregnancy, but physiotherapy will help in faster recovery from any type of delivery, whether it may be a normal or caesarean section. Although physiotherapy in the prenatal phase leads to a normal, comfortable pregnancy period, early timely delivery, faster recovery and boosting the strength and metabolism of a woman.

How Pre-Natal Physiotherapy is Planned: These sessions start from the second trimester, the 4th month of pregnancy till the start of labour. Such sessions planned during the time of labour are considered separate sessions and planned exercises. Pre-natal physiotherapy sessions are also known as antenatal physiotherapy, which comprises different exer-

cises suitable for the patient's body. The sessions are initially taken on alternate days weekly for an hour. All sessions have separate exercise regimes with proper diet counselling, breathing exercises, meditation and relaxation phases. Exercises vary patient to patient and as per the requirement, noting proper assessments done before each session. Patients are monitored with their vitals like blood pressure, blood sugar level, heart rate and respiration before and after the exercise sessions. Regular follow-ups by gynaecologists for antenatal checkups are also monitored. The couples' sessions are also being planned at the end of the trimester to provide proper counselling to the parents.

Physiotherapy at the Time of Labour: Obstetrics physiotherapy at the time of labour is nowadays con-

sidered normal and is trending a lot just to get easy, early and faster delivery naturally and with minimal labour pain. All prenatal sessions, along with obstetrics physiotherapy, help support minimal pain or painless labour during the pregnancy. The patient gets less exhausted and ultimately the foetus (baby inside the womb) gets appropriate oxygen inside the womb, which saves the baby from foetal distress. Painless or minimal pain is mostly the result of proper exercises during labour, some dietary inclusions to induce labour, reducing panic situations, music therapy and pain control modalities at the time the patient gets admitted to the hospital for labour. Physiotherapy during labour is fruitful only when there are clear signs of normal labour without any high-risk complications. The physiotherapist should take prior consent from the gynaecologist before taking the case. All gynaecologists receive proper support from the physiotherapists for the sessions.

Dr Anshul Garhpale is a pre-and post-natal, birthing & labour specialist